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碩士學位論文

美語補習班老師如何提升國小學生的自尊
以增進其英文學習成效之個案研究

A Case Study of How Language School Teachers Enhance Self-Esteem of
Elementary School Students to Facilitate English Learning

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摘 要

在今日的台灣英語教育環境中，英美語補習班佔有相當重要的地位與影響力，但是相關研究絕大多數都是以學校為主要研究環境或對象，另外，在我的教學與學習經驗中發現學生的”自尊”與學習的成效有密切關聯。因此，本研究以個案研究方式探討美語補習班老師如何提升國小學生的自尊，以增進學生的英文學習成效。其中包含些什麼成功的以及不妥當的方式，策略，技巧，言談等內容。並且討論這些成功的美語補習班老師對於英語學習與學生自尊的想法及信念。

本研究共訪談了三位資深美語補習班老師與他們的學生互動成功以及失敗的例子。並且在課堂中觀察他們與學生的互動。這三位老師的主管以及看過他們上課的同事也是訪談的對象，他們的意見能夠加深並且更客觀的來豐富研究者的觀察以及這些老師是如何來提升學生的自尊與英語學習。本研究結果發現如下：

這些老師都非常同意讚美對於提升自尊的果效，並且提到關鍵秘訣在於讚美時機的掌控，語調態度以及在怎樣的環境中，比如：同儕及家長面前的讚美更有加倍的效果。另外家長的支持與否，公平性等相關議題，畢馬龍自我實現預言的效益以及個別差異等，對於一個老師在與學生自尊互動時有決定性重要的影響。總結來說，學生，家長，美語老師，以及未來的研究者可以考量本研究的發現作為實務上的參考。

關鍵字：自尊，英語教學，國小學生，美語補習班。

ABSTRACT

To date, language schools and cram schools occupy the English educational environment in Taiwan; few studies, however, have been conducted in this setting. Besides, self-esteem has been found to be related to students' learning success. This study, thus, aims to investigate how "successful" language school teachers enhance their learners' self-esteem to facilitate better English learning, to identify or categorize the strategies or methods the teachers employ, and to study the beliefs and thoughts of the teachers when they are interacting with their learners.

To these aims, three teachers in a selected English language institute were interviewed about some cases and observed their teaching and interacting with their learners. Moreover, the teachers' supervisor, and colleagues who had observed their teaching were also interviewed to triangulate perspectives of the three teachers' and the researcher's observation. The interview contents were analyzed via the Narrative Analysis method.

Findings showed that the teachers all emphasized the good control of praise timing, tone and the occasions or conditions where the praises are provided. The teachers also claimed that parents' supports, fair issues, Pygmalion Effect and individual differences are keys to enhancing learners' self-esteem and their English learning. The results offered implications for English teachers in their daily practice as well as for parents.

Key word: self-esteem, English learning/teaching, elementary school students, language schools, cram schools.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

ABSTRACT (in Chinese).....	I
ABSTRACT (in English).....	II
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT.....	III
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	IV
LIST OF TABLES.....	VIII
LISTS OF APPENDIXES.....	VIII

CHAPTER ONE INTRODUCTION.....1

1.1 Motivation and Background.....	1
1.2 Statement of Problems.....	3
1.3 Purpose of the Study.....	5
1.4 Research Questions.....	5
1.5 Significance of the Study.....	6
1.6 Term Definition: Angle Teacher.....	8

CHAPTER TWO LITERATURE REVIEW.....9

2.1 Theoretical Aspects

2.1.1 Definitions and Types of Self-Esteem.....	9
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2.1.2 Importance of Self-Esteem.....	12
2.1.3 Self-Esteem in SLA.....	14
2.1.4 Self-Esteem Enhancement.....	15
2.2 Empirical Aspects.....	17
2.2.1 Research in Taiwan.....	17
2.2.2 Research Abroad.....	19
CHAPTER THREE METHODOLOGY.....	25
3.1 Case Study.....	25
3.2 Methods and Procedures.....	26
3.2.1 Interview.....	26
3.2.2 Class Observation.....	28
3.2.3 Triangulation.....	29
3.3 Participants.....	30
3.3.1 Teacher Anne.....	33
3.3.2 Teacher Charlotte.....	34
3.3.3 Teacher Pevin.....	36
3.4 The Role of the Researcher.....	38
3.4.1 Insider.....	38
3.4.1.1 Business vs. Education.....	39

3.4.1.2 Co-Teachers.....	39
3.4.1.3 Parents' Attitudes.....	41
3.4.2 Outsider.....	42
3.4.2.1 Subjectiveness.....	42
3.4.2.2 Objectiveness.....	42
3.5 Triangulation.....	43
3.5.1 The Supervisor, Colleagues and an Total Outsider.....	43
3.5.2 The Concerns to Ignore Parents' and Students' Perspectives.....	45
3.6 Data Analysis Method - Narrative Analysis.....	49

CHAPTER FOUR DATA ANALYSIS - ONE

THE ANGEL TEACHERS' CASES AND PHILOSOPHY.....	52
4.1 Teacher Charlotte and Robin.....	54
4.2 Teacher Charlotte's Philosophy.....	60
4.3 Teacher Pevin & Vito.....	67
4.4 Teacher Pevin & Jimmy.....	73
4.5 Teacher Pevin's Philosophy.....	77
4.6 Teacher Anne & Jack.....	82
4.7 Teacher Anne's Philosophy.....	88

CHAPTER FIVE DATA ANALYSIS - TWO

TRIANGULATIONS.....	96
5.1 The Supervisor's Perspectives - Frances to the Three Teachers.....	96
5.2 The Colleague's Perspectives - Evita to Anne.....	105
5.3 The Colleague's Perspectives - Evita to Pevin.....	111
5.4 The Colleague's Perspectives - Sharon to Anne.....	113
5.5 The Colleague's Perspectives - Sharon to Pevin.....	117
5.6 An Outsider's Perspectives - Maggie to the Three Teachers.....	118
5.7 The Researcher's Perspectives - Class Observations.....	121

CHAPTER SIX DISCUSSIONS.....124

6.1 Definitions.....	124
6.2 Models and Theories.....	127
6.3 Self-esteem in SLA.....	127
6.4 Self-esteem Enhancements.....	128
6.5 Answers to the Research Questions.....	129

CHAPTER SEVEN IMPLICATIONS & CONCLUSIONS.....137

7.1 Implications and Suggestions for Teachers & Parents - Sandwich Strategy.....	137
7.2 Limitation of this Study and Implications for Researchers.....	141

7.3 Findings of this Study and the Suggestions for Researchers.....	142
7.4 Conclusions.....	144

REFERENCES.....	145
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TABLES

1. A Comparison of the Language Institute in Research and Formal Schools.....	7
2. The Procedure of Research.....	26
3. The Three Participant Teachers' Demographic Information.....	30
4. The Functions and Main Steps of Narrative Analysis	50
5. The Data Contents.....	52
6. Labov's (1972) Basic Structures of Narrative Analysis Elements.....	163

APPENDIXES

Appendix A The Interview Questions for the Three Main Participants Teachers.....	155
Appendix B The Interview Questions for Colleagues.....	160
Appendix C The Interview Questions for the Supervisor.....	162
Appendix D An Analysis Sample.....	163

CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Motivation and Background: lost and found

I hadn't experienced a sense of achievement in my academic learning until I met the teacher who helped me realize my potential and establish my own self-esteem. Until that point, as a student, I used to position myself as the student with a nice personality, popular and friendly with my classmates. I never presented myself as the grade "A" student. I think the prime reason for this was my wanting to be popular but it, paradoxically, was also the belief that I couldn't improve my learning capabilities to any extent.

This key person who raised my self-esteem appeared when I was in the sixth grade at school. She recognized in me the ability to memorize long reading passages. She personally spent many out-of-work hours supporting me and helping me memorize such passages for reading and speech competitions. Much to my surprise, I could remember long readings and won the speech competition prize. She not only believed in me, but allowed me to nurture my own confidence with surprising results; to me she was an angel. This foundation of self-belief allowed me to start taking other school subjects seriously.

In the course of my career as a teacher in a private language institute, I have encountered learners who have expressed appreciation for helping them build up their self-esteem. This has been a rewarding but unexpected outcome and made me the angel. I have tried my best to

assist at-risk students (in terms of academic learning), to spend extra time with them and reiterate that they have the ability to change their own academic outcomes. Working together, we have learned more again and again that they could gain much better grades than previously. It's a two-way relationship; they achieved giant leaps in academic success and self-esteem, and my own ability and esteem as a teacher improved greatly.

There is one dramatic example which enlightened me. He was an at-risk student called Mark in my class. Mark behaved whatever he wanted. He read novels on his own in class and often ignored any learning activities we were practicing. I suggested Mark join a speech competition and wrote the essay with him. He became passionate to learn English at that period. Mark's mom told me that he practiced the speech even when he was showering. He did win the prize. However, after the competition, Mark went back to what he had been. I felt what I had done was in vain. I couldn't help but yell at him in class while he was behaving badly again. Mark then dropped the course of the language school for about two years. Much to my and my co-workers' surprise, he came back to look for me. While everyone working in this language institute knows this used-to-be trouble student, Mark has become polite, humble and respectful. He studied hard for learning abroad. He had come to look for me more than five times before he finally saw me and said "thank you!" Mark is another angel to me as a teacher.

My self esteem of learning in elementary life was enhanced by my angel teacher as she helped me find my capability through memorizing readings. Mark's self-esteem was enhanced

as the similar reason by me. These personal experiences of being a “helper” and “helped” in life have enlightened my understanding of a psychologist Nathaniel Branden’s observation (1987) that “all problems, except those that have a biological origin, are related to low self-esteem.” Hence, when teaching, enhancing a learner’s self-esteem is a key element and crucial factor which I deeply believe in.

1.2 Statement of Problems: ignorance & difficulties

Sometimes it is not easy to enhance the learner’s self-esteem without professional expertise or a sufficient amount of time. There are numerous cases of failure happening in the language school I worked in, which may due to different environments, teaching styles, beliefs, methods, interactions and teacher/student characteristics, etc. Some of my own teachers or the ones I have worked with have unconsciously discouraged students’ self-esteem. I myself may have also imposed this environment, but have tried to be cautiously aware of these factors and been flexible in my approaches to counter balance this situation.

There is a hopeful case happening in my class now. A student who almost always had to redo the whole pages of her homework improved her homework to be an answer-key version for other students. I found that she had no confidence at all while I first did a telephone test with her. I said, “My angel, you will progress at least by ten points if you memorize the vocabulary well.” She responded that “it’s impossible.” After that, I started to encourage her in her homework notebook for each question and answer she wrote. I wrote down numerous

appraisements. I praised her for good sentences she made and only correcting her mistaken sentences without any comments. After some days, her mom told me that she spent a whole night writing her homework to make it the best. Her homework has now become the model to other students.

Brown (2000) compiled Vigil and Oller's model (1976) for an 'error treatment' theory, which claims that "too much negative cognitive feedback ... often leads learners to shut off their attempts at communication... and providing enough red lights (which means negative cognitive feedback) to call attention to those crucial errors". Also, Skinner's (1938) 'operant conditioning' model of learning in terms of 'positive reinforcement' should also be taken into account while dealing with students to provide them positive feedback.

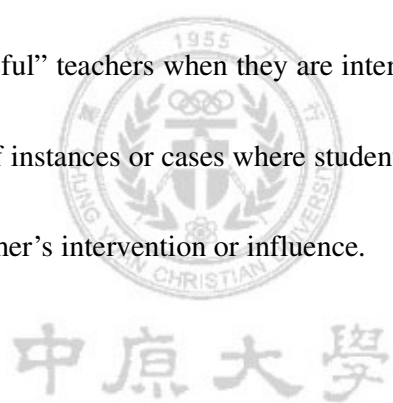
It is inspiring for all concerned when a weak or slower student starts to improve. As I have experienced these situations myself, and that the encouraging cases described earlier based on my own observation to my own students, can be due partly or even wholly to do with the students' self-esteem. The redo-homework student improved her self-esteem by her hard work and my supports.

By contrast, an excellent student may lose interest in learning if a teacher fails to attend to his/her needs. Moreover, blaming students could harm their self-esteem and cause unnecessary anxieties; however, Brown (2000) reminded that "it should not be avoided at all cost." "Students will and usually do struggle for their ego during class", subject to various and varying factors, Although no teachers would intend to damage their students' self-esteem,

teachers should realize that if they can be more careful, sensitive and professional in their interaction with their students, they will have a crucial advantage in overcoming learning difficulties that their learners exhibit.

1.3 Purpose of the Study: hope and direction

This study aims to investigate firstly how teachers can enhance their learners' self-esteem to facilitate better English learning, to secondly identify or categorize the strategies or methods that some "successful" teacher employs, and thirdly to study the beliefs and thoughts of these "successful" teachers when they are interacting with their learners. This study investigated a number of instances or cases where students' self-esteem has increased or decreased, as a result of a teacher's intervention or influence.



1.4 Research Questions: curiosity and assumption

To achieve the above aims, this research addresses the following questions:

1. How the successful language school teachers enhance elementary learners' self esteem to facilitate English learning by means of methods, strategies and so on?
2. What are the beliefs or thoughts of the teachers toward elementary learners' self-esteem in relation to English learning?
3. What influences do the teachers have on students' self-esteem?

1.5 Significance of the Study: potential & needs

The participants of this study are all from a particular language school institute. This language school differs from the usual ones where students attend, in that its main goal is to help students pass proficiency tests to be suitable candidates to study abroad. It is a language school similar to cram schools in terms of class time, but it has its own unique style with regards to such things as material (subject matters), teaching and learning methods. Its biggest divergence from elementary and high school English teaching is its unique system of teaching English. The reason for mentioning high school English learning and teaching is that the curriculum of this language school covers the contents and levels of both junior high schools and elementary schools materials.

Its curriculum does not, therefore, run simultaneously with the formal schools to provide a make up and catch up facility. It emphasizes highly on the communicative competence (Hymes, 1967) in terms of listening, speaking, reading and writing. Students learn English in English only. Phonics, reading, conversation, and writing practices are its basic curriculum design packages. Interaction, students-centered activities are the main methods for learning and teaching. It's a renowned language school chain in Taiwan.

In comparison with elementary school schedules, in this institute there are more than four hours a week for students to be exposed in English environment. In formal schools, students from the third to the sixth grade have English class for only forty minutes a week. This huge difference in the length of time between this language school and formal schools

can cause great difference in English learning efficiency. The students attending this language school in a sense can be quite different from formal school students in terms of how English is learned. For example, while students studying in formal junior high or elementary schools suffer from doing tests on translation from Chinese to English, learners in this language school are given creative and more meaningful tasks, such as making sentences according to a given context like a picture. While formal school students can't even master some basic conversations such as "How are you?" learners in this language school advance their communicative competence by discussing their daily life experiences with their teachers fluently. Below is a table where formal schools and the language school are compared in terms of pedagogical aspects.

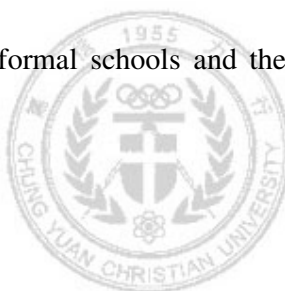


TABLE 1 A Comparison of the Language Institute in Research and Formal Schools

	Formal school	Language school
Length of time	40 minutes	200minutes
Size of class	25-35 students	5-24 students
Language usage	Chinese and English	English only
Graders	3 rd - 6 th	1 st - 6 th -9 th
Material	Integrated in functions	Separated in functions
Vocabulary	200	5388
Teaching	Teacher-centered	Student-centered
Levels	8 semesters (4 years)	16 levels (4 years)
Testing	Written	Oral and Written
Interactions	With students in class	With students and parents before, in, after class and on phones

The choice of using this specific context can contribute to the field of self-esteem and

language learning/teaching as most studies in the field of self-esteem are usually carried out in formal school settings. Although language schools and cram schools account for a large portion of the educational environment in Taiwan, a study such as this (i.e., in a language school setting) has been largely ignored. Any beneficial or harmful effects on learners in both settings should be taken into considerations.

According to the records of the electronic theses and dissertation system of National Central Library, there are about one hundred and eighty-three master and doctoral theses related to self-esteem in Taiwan. Among them, twenty eight were done in an elementary setting. However, none is related to elementary students' English learning. Besides the specialty of the research setting and the participants' backgrounds, the specialty of the research is that this study will investigate the relationship between self-esteem and elementary English learning in Taiwan.

1.6 Definition of Term: Angel Teacher

In this thesis, I specially term my own teacher who enhanced my self-esteem in my elementary life and my three main participant teachers as 'angel teachers' for some reasons. They successfully enhanced learners' self-esteem to facilitate English learning, which is a really positive influence as a significant change in learners' life. I would like to assume that they are the angels God sends in the learners' life. Therefore, any teachers who can do so will be called as 'angel teacher' by me.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Theoretical Aspects

2.1.1 Definitions and Types of Self-Esteem

William James (1890/1983), firstly, a century ago, certainly defined self-esteem mathematically as a ratio of people's actualities to their supposed potentialities.

“Self-esteem = Successes / Pretensions.”

This definition induced laughter and relieved some pressure as it seems to interpret self-esteem almost in the negative. Mathematically, this always means that the ratio is less than 1. After about a week, I thought about dropping my expectations of myself and others, which means the “pretensions; I realized that the ratio would be closer to or even greater than 1 as the “successes” will be closer to the “pretensions”. This definition is called “self-esteem” as competence.

In Christopher's (2006) view, “James' perspective is more likely to be fairly stated as a trait” types of self-esteem, but there is also a state self-esteem as well. The following terms of definition of self-esteem has been defined differently as it fluctuates in situations. For example, it has been categorized as “trait self-esteem and state self-esteem” (Leary & Downs, 1995), “stable self-esteem and unstable self-esteem” (Greenier, Kernis & Waschull, 1995) or “global self-esteem and situational self-esteem” (Harter, 1999).

Alder (1927) and Horney (1937) had a psychodynamic focus on self-esteem establishment. Christopher later distinguished the two, saying that “Alder emphasized the importance of success for building a positive sense of self and Horney focused on the difference between real and idealized selves as the central variable in developing and maintaining self-esteem.”

Additionally, based on White (1959), competence becomes a “motivational concept”, which is penetrated into the process of self-esteem building up. White takes “the experience of efficacy as the taproot of self-esteem.” White regarded the self-esteem building period as, “the mastery of developmental tasks and experiencing other successes in childhood results in feelings of effectiveness and a sense of self respect.” Therefore, students at elementary school level are still building these feelings and English teachers have the chance to assist students in achieving these successes.

Another view, which regards “self-esteem as worthiness”, was introduced by Rosenberg (1965): “Self-esteem is a positive or negative attitude toward a particular object, namely, the self. High self-esteem, as reflected in our scale items, expresses the feeling that one is “good enough.”

This is an interesting definition because of the term “our” scale items. This suggests that it’s our own observed and defined “self” views which are not objectively defined our sense of ‘self’ to be positive or negative. This means that we define our self-esteem by our own parameters and not anything agreed or existing externally as much. We are encouraged and

discouraged by our own “self scales”. Wylie (1974) stated that people seemed blind to this “self scales” concept because, “the self perceiver is also the object of perception.”

Nevertheless, others don’t necessarily take this view. Baumeister, Smart, and Boden (1996) defined self-esteem as “a favorable global evaluation of one’s self that the sense of superiority shares highly fundamental meaning of favorable global self-esteem.”

Compared to competence, worthiness emphasizes the feelings toward self and competence focuses more on the cognition of self. Nathaniel Branden (1969) firstly integrated the two aspects of definitions of self-esteem, “Self-esteem has two interrelated aspects: it entails a sense of personal efficacy and a sense of personal worth.” He linked efficiency to confidence and worthiness to respect. He takes self-esteem as a conviction that ‘one is competent to live and worthy of living.” Based on these definitions, there are models and theories of self-esteem establishing models and enhancing self-esteem methods explained, invented and applied.

For instance, Frey and Carlock’s (1989) “Eclectic Variations on a Humanistic Theme” focuses on the co-existence of the value of an individual’s weakness and strength to enhance self-esteem.

Pope, McHale & Craighead’s (1988) “Increasing Self-Esteem Behaviorally” emphasizes the academic, social, familial and physical domains of an individual which highly rely on the important others who deeply understand the helped individual.

Bendnar, Wells & Peterson’s (1989) “Enhancing Self-Esteem Cognitively” strategies are

to induce the individual to face the conflict or anxiety that they have escaped from.

Harter's (1999) "Developmental Approach" values "the multidimensional model of self-esteem that is tied to development and this requires a multidimensional assessment of the individual".

Burns' (1993) "Ten Days to Self-Esteem" programs provide quite clear and direct activities to enhance self-esteem, too. These are applied to the definitions and theories of self-esteem. There are basic ideas, systems and techniques in these programs to be conducted into practice.

2.1.2 Importance of Self-Esteem

The importance of self-esteem is strongly emphasized by some Christian psychologists. Adams (1986) agreed with the views of some Christians that self-esteem is important and stated that "proper self esteem is the secret to life and most of its problem." Interestingly, he chose the word 'proper' rather than the word 'high' with regards to self-esteem. Being on the more appropriate point of a continuum is truly hard; too much one way, one would feel superior and struck-up; the other way, inferior and lowly. There is probably a long distance between the two extremes but the challenge would be how to achieve this proper point.

Adams recorded further words from a view point of Dobson (1975) who is a psychologist and a Christian that "they would provide women with a healthy dose of self-esteem and personal worth as they have no doubt that this is the greatest need of

them”(p.35).

Adams (1986) cited many statements with regards to the importance of self-esteem. One which attracted my attention the most was stated by Fallaw (1954) that “all these difficulties of yours have their root in the self-esteem of our natures. (p.96)” This attributes difficulties with self-esteem as wholly the problem or “root”, which corresponds to the stated interpretation of a nature, is similar to the interpretation of Branden (1987) that “all problems, except those that have a biological origin, are related to low self-esteem.”

Christopher (2006) also related self-esteem to learning difficulties, “low self-esteem is often mentioned in regard to various mental disorders, such as depression, anxiety and learning problems”. This last statement really summarizes why there is still such an interest in the importance of self-esteem in English learning.

Adams also referred to “the need to be loved” by several other theories; hypothesis such as the Maslow’s (1970) Hierarchical Needs Model etc. I do agree that being loved is a really high level state of being esteemed and being loved enhanced one’s self-esteem very much. Another citation from Jepson (1984), a Christian, who is also a psychologist, described the interaction between love and self-esteem as important. “If no one loves us, how will we ever know our value and significance? If we are to have the valuable attitude toward ourselves, we must be esteemed and valued (p.167).”

The above mentioned psychologists not only analyzed people’s problems and difficulties, but also produced theories and provided research data to point out the importance of

self-esteem to overcome people's anxieties.

Everyday, people understand the importance of their feelings of self worth and value. I, myself, went through a process of re-building my self-esteem and subsequently my learning capabilities, especially in the subject, English. I therefore recognized the importance of self-esteem and tried to enhance my students' abilities as well. It is a two-way relationship; one way is my students' self-esteem enhancement and the other is their improvements, which in turn enhances my self-esteem.

2.1.3 Self-esteem in SLA

In addition to the trait and state self-esteem, there is another dimension of self-esteem in the literature, which is called "task self-esteem". According to Brown (2000), "Task self-esteem relates to particular tasks within specific situations" which can include foreign language learning." Brown linked self-esteem and second language learning as "state self-esteem might encompass second language acquisition in general, and task self-esteem might appropriately refer to one's self-evaluation of a particular aspect of process: speaking, writing ... or even a special kind of classroom exercise."

Heyde (1979) studied the effects of trait, state and task self-esteem and college students' foreign language learning. She found that the three levels of self-esteem are correlated positively especially in oral performance.

However, the interactions between self-esteem and foreign or second language learning

performance are still like chicken-egg questions for researchers, as we are not sure if comparatively high self-esteem causes language success or language success causes higher self-esteem. Brown concluded that they are interacting factors. Luckily, we seem to be able to be sure that “successful teachers give attention to both linguistic goals and personhood” (Andrés, 1999).

2.1.4 Self-Esteem Enhancement

There are numerous and various books and programs which provide skills, techniques or strategies of enhancing self-esteem in children. These following statements for parents can be applied by teachers for their learners. Carlson (1988) suggested that “parents’ understanding of how to speak to their children is the requirement in building self-esteem in families”. There are the nine sentences Carlson wanted parents to consider:

1. “If no one said, “I love you,” we would doubt our lovable-ness!
2. If no one said, “I am glad you were born into our family,” we would doubt our belonging!
3. If no one said, “I can see you have done a good job,” we would doubt our capability!
4. If no one said, “I need you”, we would doubt our value!
5. If no one said, “It’s okay to feel,” we would doubt our humanness!
6. If no one said, “I forgive you,” we would doubt our okay-ness!

7. If no one said, “Hello,” we would doubt our existence!

8. If no one said, “It’s okay to think,” we would doubt our independence!

9. If no one says “God loves you,” we would doubt our internal significance!”

~Carlson (1988) ~

These sentences express the needs, respects, love and admirations to an individual, some of which I have heard from my own angel teacher who had spoken them to me and the chosen teachers who had spoken to their students and were the participants of this research.

Another touching self-esteem enhancement strategy was able to be done in words or other forms (such as attitude and emotions). It is a poem called “Children learn what they live” by Dorothy Law Nolte. It was collected in Canfield and Wells’ (1976) “100 ways to enhance self-concept in the classroom”. The first part of the poem depicts what a child can turn out to be if he/she lives in a negative environment. Thus, the second and the third part describe positive environments where a child can turn out to be.

“If a child lives with criticism, he learns to condemn. If a child lives with hostility, he learns to fight. If a child lives with fear, he learns to be apprehensive. If a child lives with pity, he learns to feel sorry for himself. If a child lives with ridicule, he learns to be shy. If a child lives with jealousy, he learns what envy is. If a child lives with shame, he learns to feel guilty.

If a child lives with encouragement, he learns to be confident. If a child lives

with tolerance, he learns to be patient. If a child lives with praise, he learns to be appreciative. If a child lives with acceptance, he learns to love. If a child lives with approval, he learns to like himself. If a child lives with recognition, he learns that it is good to have a goal. If a child lives with sharing, he learns about generosity. If a child lives with honesty and fairness, he learns what truth and justice are.

If a child lives with security, he learns to have faith in himself and in those about him. If a child lives with friendliness, he learns that the world is a nice place in which to live. If you live with serenity, your child will live with peace of mind.

With what is your child living?”



~Dorothy Law Nolte~

中原大學

The second and third parts have implications for teachers. Teachers can facilitate students' self-esteem by providing facilitative conditions or words.

To conclude, Carlson (1988) claimed that “words hurt as much as sticks and stones”. On the other hand, I believe “words help as much as presents and rewards.”

2.2 Empirical Aspects

2.2.1 Research in Taiwan

From 1988 to 2009, among five hundred and twenty-seven master or doctoral studies

done in Taiwan on English learning, so far there seems to be only one related to research on self-esteem done by Chen (2004). This research is related to senior high school students. Chen (2004) cited four unpublished theses as she was presenting these outcomes related to self-esteem in Taiwan, while the other three studies were journalistic articles. Her study encouraged me to realize the possible significance of my study. There are truly not sufficient studies on self-esteem and its effects on language learning, in Taiwan.

In 2006, there was research conducted by Chang (2006) on elementary students. This was a quantitative research on the relationship among self-esteem, learning strategies and procrastination. Procrastination is also a common problem encountered by both my participant teachers and myself in our everyday teaching lives. It refers to the delay of assignments performed by elementary students in their subjects learning. The goal of Chang's study was to figure out how the three variables (which refers to self-esteem, learning strategies and procrastination) are related and to what extent. Her conclusions included not only how important self esteem is and its benefits, but also that an elementary student suffers the less procrastination problems, the better his/her self-esteem and learning outcomes will be. It would seem that there is a direct correlation between self-esteem and behavior of lightened procrastination. So, if self-esteem can benefit from less procrastination, then this would improve learning as well.

Another interesting outcome which came to light was that there was a more pronounced problem of procrastination with boys than girl in the above study. This seems to imply that

self-esteem among girls in this context may be comparatively higher than boys’.

This practical study is related to my topic, mostly, in terms of the age of subjects, the discussed issues and some of the solutions to the problems.

The importance of self-esteem is self-evident given the research studies done by other researchers in Taiwan. For example:

“Instability of self-esteem predicts emotions of depression significantly”. (Lin, 2004)

“People with low self-esteem are sensitive to negative emotions such as remorse, solitude, helpless and jealous feelings.” (Lin, 2003, Lin, 2006 & Liu, 2000)

“People with higher self-esteem tend to be more capable of raising satisfaction of self and raising global self-esteem.” (Wu, 2000 and Lee, 2004)

To summarize, related research studies on self-esteem in Taiwan seemed to have concentrated on both the “competence” and the “worthiness” dimensions of self-esteem.

2.2.2 Research Abroad

Christoper’s (2006) master work called “Self-Esteem Research, Theory, and Practice” provides fruitful research findings and their organized categories. Based on my understanding of my working environment, and the problems my participants encounter and deal with, I chose two of Christoper’s (2006) research findings classifications related to my study. They are “parental factors” and “effective self-esteem enhancing techniques”.

The other reason I chose these two particular categories, “parental factor” and “effective

self-esteem enhancing techniques”, from Christopher is that I assume that the “parental factor” is a source of students’ self-esteem problems with regards to learning difficulties. The “effective self-esteem enhancing techniques” employed by the teachers, I assume can be a solution for some students, to facilitate greater learning to some extent for them.

The parental factors include sub-categories such as “parental support (involvement)”, “warmth (acceptance)”, “expectations”, “consistency”, “parenting styles” and “birth order”.

In the studies in relation to parental support (involvement), as Christopher compiled, Burger (1995) pointed out that “the efficacious feelings associated with mastery are helpful in the development of self-esteem, and that parents who encourage their children offer more positive support than those who do not”.

Clark and Barber (1994), Coopersmith (1967) and Rosenberg (1965) had similar findings in their studies that parents who are described as being indifferent toward their children, as well as parents who are absent for long periods of time, tend to have children with lower levels of self-esteem.

More importantly, this effect may be particularly important for male children (Miller, 1984). However, Burnett, Anderson and Heppner (1995), found that males’ self-esteem is relatively higher than females, and it resulted from the value of the society toward males and females. The main reason can be that males received more positive value in their society. These findings were conducted with adult participants.

In addition to the shift of low or high self-esteem formation among children and adults,

the importance of developmental stage had been emphasized. Shaffer (1996) had claimed that children self-esteem enhancement rely highly on the significant others and the environments around them, in comparing to teenagers and adults.

Culturally, “the birth order” is also an important issue in Taiwan as I have experienced myself or by observing my students’ families’ problems. It seems that the elder kids always take more responsibilities and are more mature than the followers, and the youngest one seems to be always spoiled easily. There are for sure opposite cases in the “birth order” issue.

The “effective self esteem enhancing techniques” section includes sub-sections like “the importance of being accepting and caring”, “providing consistent, positive (affirming) feedback”, and enhancing self-esteem by “assertiveness training (empowerment)”, “increasing problem solving skills”. These are significant positive parenting behavior to provide supports in building self-esteem in children. As Bhatti, Derezotes, Kim, and Specht (1989) summed it up, “Many experts suggest focusing on positive rather than negative behavior to begin building self-esteem.”

In addition to “parental factors” and “effective self-esteem enhancing techniques”, in schools, what teachers do affects students’ self-esteem. Branden (1996) considered the factors that affect students’ self-esteem at schools are “educational goals”, “teachers’ self-esteem” and the “environments of classroom”.

The “educational goals” refers to the global goals of the teacher’s education. The “teachers’ self-esteem means the self-esteem of the teacher herself or himself. Some teachers

who work in my language school perform relatively low self-esteem as they might easily take things personally rather than professionally. They take students inappropriate behavior as their problems to cause this result, and then they tend to blame students for their behaviors. They might suppose that why they were trying to hurt the teachers by doing so. Such ungrounded accusations harm students' self-esteem as they were misunderstood.

A teacher with more proper self-esteem tend to suppose a student's inappropriate behavior as a understandable phenomenon which might result from the individual's learning difficulties or poor learning habits, which is seen as more professionally because the teacher understands that the students were not trying to hurt him/her.

The third one "classroom environment" represents the way the teacher treats and interacts with all the students. This concept indirectly implies the value of the "fair" issue. That being fair to treat and interact with students is a crucial behavioral principle for teachers to at least, passively prevent from hurting students' self-esteem.

Two more quantitative research studies conducted in Haiti related to self-esteem and the students' English proficiency are related to my study. For examples, Myrick (1989) carried out a research study on ninth and tenth- grade students who had behavioral problems like anxiety, depression, low motivation, low energy and underachievement, which had been found to be attributed to low self-esteem. This study had a project done to improve their self-concept and achievement. Myrick used the Piers-Harris (1984) Self-Concept Inventory scale, a behavioral checklist, an oral language test and a written English test as pretests. After

the pretest, there were various activities conducted to improve students' self-concept such as museum group activities, sports games, televisions, recordings, field trips and inter-ethnic group fair activities. They conducted a posttest including the written English test, behavior checklist, description of language proficiency levels, a letter to parents, and a checklist for parents to help their children in school and class work samples. The posttest showed the improvement of students' self-concept and their learning outcomes.

Another study was also done in Haiti. Bien-Aime (1995) conducted a study with aims to reduce the failure and potential dropout rate of 9th-grade Haitian students whose English proficiency was comparatively low. These students studied in bilingual classes and were selected by their bilingual teachers. They had behavior problems and failed in two or more subjects. The Piers-Harris Self-Concept Inventory and the Demos Dropout Scale (Demos, 1986 from Wells, Miller, & Clanton, 1999) were used as measurement instruments. Students were planned to meet counselors or social workers for 50 minutes. They met one day per week and it lasted for ten weeks. The activities explored three areas which are essential in self-esteem development. The three developmental areas are a sense of belonging; a sense of competence; and a sense of worth-while-ness. The results indicated increased levels of achievement compared with the students' pretest. To conclude, building positive self-esteem improves academic achievement in this study.

A reason explains the improvement of academic achievement that results from self-esteem enhancement can be that "children will not use their full ability if their

self-esteem is low”. This definite conclusion was given by numerous researchers such as Crocker and Wolfe, (2001), Galbraith and Alexander, (2005), Mrak, (1999) and Rosenberg et al., 1995 all of whom carried out research with children participants. This research conclusion easily earned my agreement as I don’t even want to try my best to do something then, don’t perform well when I don’t believe I could.

In conclusion, compared with research in Taiwan, research abroad related to self-esteem seems to provide more clear cut findings in terms of definitions, significances, developmental stages, gender issues and so on.



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CHAPTER THREE

METHODOLOGY

3.1 Case Study:

Three Individual Cases: here come the angel teachers

I conducted a qualitative research. I chose the method of Case Study as my research method. Hu (2003) compiled quite concise and precise points of the good usages of taking case study as a main research method. As Hu interpreted that Yin (1984) had provided a number of appropriate contexts for a researcher to choose case study as the research method.

They are as follows:

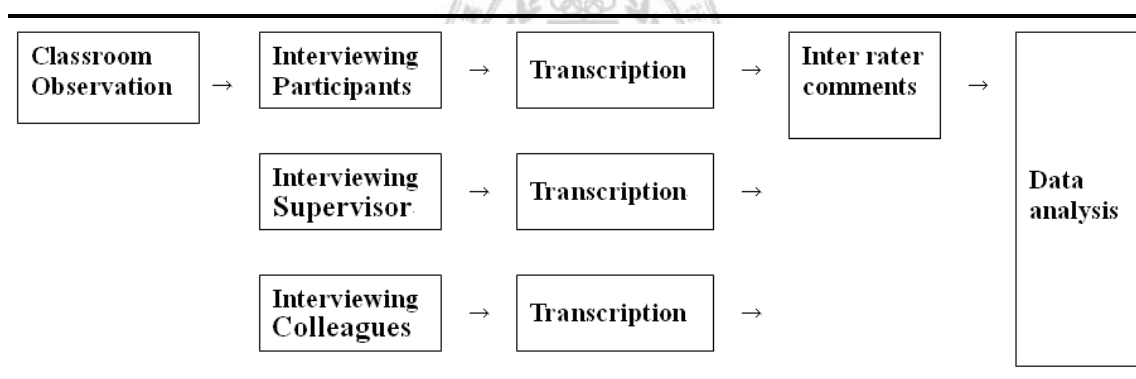
1. The process and the reasons of a factor is the aim a researcher wants to understand.
2. The factor happens naturally.
3. The factor happens in the reality of life.

Yin (1984) mentioned that case study can include triangulation to a particular subject, an action and a factor with in-depth and detailed investigation. Lin (1988) also stated that case study applied in educational contexts can help the researchers understand the problems of education in reality. The interest of a researcher is on the process rather than the results, and the researcher hopes to contribute the phenomenon back to the foundation or root of education.

I was interested in the process of my participants' interactions with students, which cause successful or failed outcomes in terms of self-esteem enhancement. These cases did happen in reality. More significantly, I assumed that self-esteem is one of the major factors that cause learning or teaching frustrations and difficulties. So, this was truly an appropriate method for my research.

3.2 Methods and Procedures

TABLE 2 The Procedures of Research



3.2.1 Interview:

Three teachers were chosen as my participants and interviewed individually with recording equipment. This was a semi-structural interview. Because, there were question types for them to share experiences and situations rather answering correct items. The interview questions were what they do to enhance learners' self-esteems, which is the surface behavior and what they believe, what they hope to achieve about their strategies to enhance self-esteem,

which were the underlying principles in the teachers' minds.

Besides interviewing the participants, I also interviewed the three teachers' supervisor and their colleagues who had observed their teaching just like me. Moreover, I invited another elementary school English teacher as another triangulation doer. The reason to do these was to confirm or challenge the three participants' and my accounts and to discuss if their ways to enhance learners' self-esteem could reach agreements among teachers.

The Interview Questions for Participants

The interview questions for the participant teachers, colleagues, supervisors and another triangulation doer teacher were somewhat different. For example, the questions for the participant teachers included both the experiences of interacting with students and their belief, thoughts toward self-esteem and English learning. The questions for others mainly focused on the thoughts toward the participant teachers' teaching and interacting with students. The questions for the supervisor included the perspectives of being a supervisor rather than merely being colleagues. (See Appendix A to C).

The teachers were informed beforehand of the interview questions to allow them to prepare and recall their teaching memories and experiences. The reason behind this was to allow the teachers to think both positive and negative teaching experience, how they handled them, what they learned from these experiences, and any progress, enhancement or decrease they found in their students' self-esteem.

The participants' identities were protected to ensure honesty, open answers and sharing sad experiences as well. Sad experiences provided in-depth insights into behaviors and beliefs which are detrimental to all. This allowed teacher trainees to be vigilant and avoid similar pitfalls.

Out-of-classroom situations and experiences were covered as well, to give a whole aspect of interaction, and not just in the confines of a more formal classroom setting. These fruitful, in-depth discussions led to further preparation and comprehension interviews.

Interview time length wasn't fixed or limited in order to build up a rapport and gain as much information as possible. The interview contents were transcribed for analysis.

3.2.2 Classroom Observation

I observed each teacher's teaching about at least six to nine hours before the interview, to make my interview questions more specific to each of them, which means there were some extra different questions to different subjects due to their specialties. I had earned oral permission from my participants that I was allowed to video-record their teaching for at least four hours in case I miss any important factors or elements in their teaching to make up my observation notes. I wrote about their facial expressions, tones, attitudes, language expressions while interacting with learners in my observation notes. I also asked questions related to what I observed in class, and this gave me a chance to confirm my understandings and interpretation of what the teacher did to enhance their students' self-esteem.

The observation allowed the teachers to be able to affirm what they set out to achieve (knowing the interview questions first) and I gained even more information. Moreover, the reason to do observation first and interview later was that I wanted to show my respect to them and give them questions to ponder. In this language school, teachers are observed by supervisors without being informed beforehand and by new teachers while being informed. The observations thus function as a “double check” rather than experience sharing sometimes. So, I hoped that I can provide them with chances to clarify for themselves rather than checking out if they had achieved what they said in the interview.

In summary, the observation was designed to allow me to have my interview questions more suitable for individual teachers; to see the teachers in practice, and give a sense of reality to the self-esteem practices I was investigating.

3.2.3 Triangulation

To look at one thing from different angles, my data sources included interviews, observations and inter-rater comments for me to make the phenomenon under investigation more objective. In the studies of Language Testing, the reliabilities and validities of raters are a significant issue discussed, as the accuracy and consistency of the ratings are the base of fairness for any participants of the test. Weir and Wu (2006) recorded that some language proficiency tests from 1985 to 1999 had involved inter-rater system. Inter-rater reliability had been taken into consideration while doing composition rating in several proficiency tests, but

it is more likely to be a quantitative usage. There are two thesis studies done in Taiwan by Wang (2007) and Sung (2008), both of which take inter-rater method in their qualitative research methods in relation to English learning and writing improvement. Applying from these professional concerns, I asked an outsider who never works in the language institute and is a formal elementary school teacher involved in my studies to interpret and comment on my transcripts to make it more objective and some other insiders who are the three main participant teachers' colleagues and supervisor.

3.3 Participants

Table three provides brief information of the three participant teachers' specialties and background information. They will also be described in more details in the paragraphs that follow.

TABLE 3 Background Information of the Three Main Participant Teachers

(2009, Dec)

Name	Words of Mouths	The Best Observation Models
Anne	Parents: The best choice: learning behavior formation	The Best Classroom management

Charlotte	Parents:	The Best
	The best choice: biological problems	Class Atmosphere creation
Pevin	Parents:	The Best Confidence
	The best choice: beginning level	building

Three language school English teachers who I had worked with for years joined this study. They were all in their early forties and had worked for this language school both as full-time and part-time teachers for ten years or more.

They are all of a senior level, high enough to run major activities such as speech competition and have been chosen as models and trainers for new teachers. They had been the trainers for the national training for this language institute, which means their teachings gain approval not only in Taichung area but also elsewhere in Taiwan.

Ironically, they did not major in English or language teaching. They perform their outstanding teaching abilities and share patient and passionate teaching philosophy with English-majored teacher trainees. The reasons might be that they possess not only linguistic professions but also inspiring teaching/learning philosophy.

They have worked in other language or cram school systems in terms of material, levels, teaching/learning methods, and class sizes.

I have observed the teachings of the three teachers. Moreover, I have observed more than forty teachers' teachings at least twice since four or five years ago and the three impressed me

the most in both their teaching and their interactions with learners.

Their teaching is efficient and effective. Their careful classroom management techniques do not allow students to pay less attention as for sure. Learners' learning effect will decrease if students miss any material or any practice in activities.

The three teachers concern attracting their students' attention in class, so they always try to design sufficient activities and manage their class in an effective way. Therefore, their students are usually equally good in the four macro aspects of language, i.e., listening, speaking, reading and writing. Their learning outcomes in grades do not range very differently.

Observing their interaction with their classes, I identified that they are good research subjects to follow with regard to enhancing learners' self-esteem. They talk gently to their students, encouraging them often, both verbally and with written comments in their students' notebooks.

They appear popular with their students, probably as a result of increased understanding and self-esteem issue.

They spend time and money to buy or make some rewarding props for their students, and the language school teachers follow as a tradition. They praise and motivate their students whilst communicating affectively with them and their parents.

They maintain cohesive relationships with all parties and rarely blame or belittle any relationship development issues.

Due to this professional and caring attitude, I chose these participants for this study. I chose these teachers as my participants because of their professional and empathetic characters. I will mention some of their personal details with regard to educational background and their work experience.

3.3.1 Teacher Anne

Teacher Anne is the second most senior teacher, with more than ten years of teaching experience in various contexts. She graduated from the Academy of Art University of San Francisco, majoring in Interior Design. She was an interior designer in Taiwan for about three years after she graduated. Anne had to shift jobs and became an English teacher after the 9/21 earthquake as she lost the interior designer job due to her company's bankruptcy after the earthquake.

She initially worked as a full-time teacher in the language school before switching to part-time teaching for the next seven years. During this switch, she worked in other English cram school system, and was a tutor for five years.

For her supervisors, she is one of their first choices to conduct theme-based courses such as GEPT (General English Proficiency Test) classes. Nearly eight-tenths of her students are at elementary level. One of her strengths is her ability to communicate in writing format. She confidently stated, "Hand writing is one of the important keys to students' self-confidence building." Her handwriting is a great model to the new teachers.

Anne will use her off-work periods to do full make-up lessons for students who have been absent because she recognizes that, “Students will give up learning new things if they feel anxious about the unfamiliar, due to the missed lesson. So, I prepared them and do a make up before they step into the next lesson.” She strongly recommended me to do the same.

Even though she may have taught a lesson several times, she always takes time to prepare the lesson as it were the first time and she was going to have the class for their first time.

Anne was the first teacher I observed and her classroom management, which includes authority, deeply impressed me. The children behaved like soldiers, responding and obeying the commands which teacher Anne gave so consistently and authoritatively.

Even though students are well-trained, they won't become fixed. In the beginning levels, teacher-centered teaching/learning activities may be the main teaching method. If it is a high level class taught by Teacher Anne, it's otherwise easier for students to shift to a students-centered method since she has had her students well-trained. She is the most organized teacher I have ever met.

3.3.2 Teacher Charlotte

The most senior teacher in this study is **Teacher Charlotte**. She has been an English teacher for more than ten years and graduated from Ontario Art College in Canada. She majored in both Graphic Design and Animated Design which were not that popular in Taiwan

fifteen years ago. Upon her return to Taiwan, she couldn't find an appropriate job in her chosen profession. She was extremely sad that it seemed she learnt something which wasn't valued in her own country. Even now she said it's easy to forget her skills if she doesn't practice them for a week or so.

However, she learnt English in Canada and this did help in Taiwan, so she considered teaching English as a second profession. Similar to Teacher Anne, she came to the English language school as a full-time teacher for two years and then switched to part-time teaching for more than seven years.

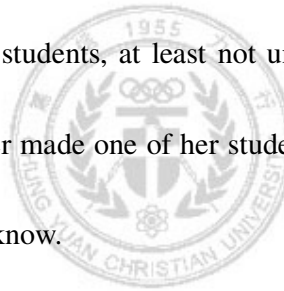
She also worked for other cram schools with different systems. She is a very popular choice for new students in the cram school. Parents will more readily sign up to new classes if they are provided with information stating Charlotte as the class teacher. One of the reasons is simply word-of-mouth; students at their formal school discuss how nice, interesting and encouraging she is, and these words pass through to other parents. The students then turn up to cram school learning activities run by Charlotte, out of curiosity and sign up. There are no incentives or rewards for the original students, just the attraction, simply of teacher Charlotte.

Once I discussed with Charlotte my method of removing points from students, as a punishment. She interrupted me and said that she always rewarded points to praise students rather than taking points off as punishment. By doing this, it inspired the lower level students to gain rather than to lose points.

Spontaneously, I would have a chance to observe one of her classes, which was like a

variety show. The students always appear happy and laughter can be heard throughout their oral practice. They are allowed to be crazy and make extraordinary sentences with strange words to learn their sentence patterns. This allows them to be expressive and creative like this teacher.

She also puts her animation skills to good use, drawing pictures and illustrations in class, which is a precious gift. These grab the students' attention and she helps and encourages her students to draw, helping their hands with the pen/marker if she feels they are nervous. "I suffered enough insults about how I was not able to answer a math question. So, I don't want this misery to be suffered by my students, at least not under my supervision" she seriously screamed when a substitute teacher made one of her students cry. She is the most interesting, humorous and emphatic teacher I know.



中原大學

3.3.3 Teacher Pevin

My final participant is the queen of classroom management, **Teacher Pevin**. Pevin graduated from Hung-Kuang University in Taiwan, majoring in nursing. Then she transferred to Tung-Hai University, majored in Animal Science and Biotechnology. Meanwhile, she took courses in the Department of Foreign Languages and Literatures. She worked as a nurse for one year when she studied in Hung-Kuang University and for four years after graduating from Tung-Hai University. Due to the unstable working period of nursing, she quit.

Then, she worked in this language school as a full time teacher for three and half years

and a part time teacher for more than nine years. Similar to Anne and Charlotte, she has worked in many different branches of this language school in the Taichung area. This means that they have all had different supervisors that have had different teaching values and requirements.

She is a combination of a commander and a host of a variety show. Pevin impressed me greatly with her super active class. She doesn't give points or rewards during or after class whilst her students are actively listening, answering questions or performing well. She has taught and trained her students in the realization that learning is their own responsibility by informing them that speaking and communicating in English are their own rights and duty.

She taught me ideas about class management especially how to efficiently and artfully conduct the management methods. Saying something can be easy but putting words into practice, but can be more challenging. She not only taught me these ideas but helped me and reminded me, as to how to deal with disruptive students with her examples, the best way to solve any issues and maintain my class efficiently.

With this advice I managed to overcome any classroom management issues much quicker than the other new teachers. "Giving extra chances for practice to weak or slower students by facilitation is the most direct and efficient way to build their confidence. It gives them the best chance to believe in themselves and achieve what the others can, and that they are able to complete assignments almost by themselves," Pevin suggested to me, while I was sharing some of my frustrations about weaker students with her. Pevin is one of the most

direct and honest teachers I have ever known.

She has also invented a number of useful and efficient methods to improve aspects of learning in creative and interesting ways. For example, the students' telephone test is a challenging part of the job both in terms of communication and time management. Some of the questions seem overly meaningless and irrelevant to the students in terms of their age and interests. Pevin decided to improve the design of these questions, by combining them in a topic-related discussion with her students. "In this way, I can elicit students sharing experiences actively instead of answering questions passively," Pevin stated. "Students tend to speak and think more about their experience, and express themselves using the pattern and vocabulary they've just learnt in previous lessons." Pevin shared with me her new process, with enthusiasm as she gained the positive responses she'd expected. I have now started to utilize the same procedure. The students' parents were surprisingly happy as well because they could hear their children speaking English in whole paragraphs, not just sentences, and they weren't reading it from a page in a book.

There might be a curiosity that how come they are all female ones. Actually, the male teacher ratio of this language institute is relatively low to some extent that I do not know one so that I am not able to locate a male one.

3.4 The Role of the Researcher

3.4.1 Insider

As a fellow teacher in the language school, I have chance to observe my participants, converse with them, reflect on their teaching with them, and communicate with students' parents. The reason to mention the role of the researcher is because that not only it is a traditional concern of qualitative research but also I am, actually, one of the participants of this study where I play the role of the insider in the research context and the role of an outsider while observing my three main participants' classes.

Most significantly, I get first-hand knowledge and a chance to realize the problems and frustration of working within this language school environment. There are three major frustrations encountered by me and my participants: "business challenges education", "co-teacher communication", and "parents' attitude". These problems can affect teachers negatively even though they have to keep their spirits up to facilitate learning and deal with learners' self-esteem patiently and passionately. These main problems can only be explained clearly as an insider who has experiences and feelings on them. They are as follows:

3.4.1.1 Business vs. Education

The aim of this job, as a teacher, is to ensure that we facilitate sufficient learning of our students. As supervisors, their roles seem to demand not only maximal learning sufficiency but also maximum of profit margins; this seems to be a bit of a hard task, to earn profits through education and to balance education with profit. As one teacher may not be able to tell the truth about kids' problems to the parents to solve learning difficulties, in this case, they

might lose customers if they offend them by doing so.

3.4.1.2 Co-Teachers

This language school hires native speaker teachers, and was in fact started by a native-speaker teacher. There are both pros and cons to both Chinese speaking teachers and native speaker teachers. Some think that Chinese speaking teachers can help students initially with the language barrier, giving clearer instructions in Chinese, whilst others believe that native-speakers can help students understand and recognize accents and help in listening and speaking pronunciation and intonation. Interaction between the two can be a little negative sometimes due to the difference in cultural diversities and values, which can create gaps in understanding.

The competitive nature of things in Taiwan is little understood by native speaker teachers; they often think it's a crazy, nervous way to live in contrast to their life back to their countries. One native speaker teacher told me that she felt that Taiwanese students had little free time after school.

These teachers have to teach twelve to thirteen classes a week, and such a heavy schedule meant they forgot students or co-teachers' names. The Chinese-speaking teachers co-teach with the native ones and also by themselves while there are not enough native speaker teachers or they are absent, so the Chinese teachers don't teach more than about six classes a week.

Due to the high turnovers of native speaker teachers, it affects not only the relationships and familiarities between both sets of teachers, but also the quality of teaching. New incoming native speaker teachers need to get used to the job, lifestyle, different expectations and the students in a very short space of time. They are trained quite intensely in a short period of time and don't always get to put their training into practice. Subsequently, the Chinese speaker teachers, who get paid a lot less, are expected to "coach" these new teachers, if they care about their students' progress. The distance between the inconsistencies of pay has been an unsolved problem for years. Co-teaching with a senior and experienced native speaker teacher becomes, ironically, a serious plus in terms of working environment.

3.4.1.3 Parents' Attitudes

Another problem arising in this teaching format is called the redo system. This basically means if a student does not reach a certain level in passing tests, homework performance or other aspect of the curriculum, he/she will have to re-study the level. This does not please their parents, who pay quite a lot of money for this education.

Some of them view this 'problem' as purely the responsibility of teachers, as they got paid for it. There seems to be little respect or understanding for the language school profession in terms of expectation, assignments, environment or students' presence consistency. If their children perform worse than their expectation, it seems acceptable to solely blame the teachers.

Probably one of the biggest frustrations for a teacher in the classroom is the laid-back attitude of a student. The expectations of pushy or anxious parents and their troublesome children make it quite difficult for a teacher to compromise her/his own teaching and the parents' requests. A number of spoiled students view this language school as nothing to concern themselves with; they don't try or bother with their assignments. After trying to communicate with their parents, you sometimes realize why the students behave as such and there is little you can do to change the situation. This attitude can almost make a teacher feel useless and give in.

We could easily forget the importance of building up students' confidence and motivating them to learn English. This could be the time when teachers lost control and their emotions could damage a student's self-esteem.

These frustrations from parents, co-teachers and business make me realize how the admirable successful teachers are, who control their emotions and keep their patience and passion while dealing with students' self-esteem, and even parents' ones.

3.4.2 Outsider

3.4.2.1 Subjectiveness

I as a researcher can position myself as an outsider as well. I observed classes and listened to the teachers sharing their experiences. I hadn't been through the processes involving interaction between the teachers and their classes, as they couldn't possibly share

the whole story without missing something. It could have been easy for me to misunderstand or misjudge their responses to their students.

For example, subjectively, I may view their response as impatient to a student, without knowing the student's history or I may not agree with their solution to a problem without knowing the student's individual difficulties. It is probably impossible for a teacher not to treat their own students differently, as individuals, which may seem unfair, but is more than normal. As, if a teacher can't take considerations of individual differences, he/she won't be able to take good care of each "individuals".

3.4.2.2 Objectiveness

On the other hand, I have the advantages to look at the cases under investigation more objectively as an outsider. I can observe the teachers' and their learners' perspectives while they are interacting. Taking advantages of the understanding of my participants for years, I can be more sensitively aware what they miss or ignore in their interaction with their learners to cause whether positive or negative influence on learners' self-esteem. This can compensate the limitation of the subjectiveness to some extent.

3.5 Triangulation

3.5.1 The Supervisor, Colleagues and a Total Outsider

In my research design, there were three angles of my triangulation. They are the three

successful teachers' two colleagues, one supervisor and a total outsider, teacher Maggie who works as a formal school teacher now. Besides being a formal school teacher, she has more fruitful background to facilitate the triangulation. I would like to firstly introduce her here. As for the two colleagues and the supervisor, their background information will be introduced with their sharing in Chapter Five along with their interview analysis.

Teacher Maggie, who I knew when I worked as a substitute teacher in Jhung-Hua elementary school is a successful angel teacher, too. There are also professional and empathetic concerns of my selection of her. The professional and empathetic concerns are explained as followed. The main reason is that I found my self-esteem improved in the interaction with her. She always reminds me the value of a problem or a trouble I was dealing with. She is the most positive person I have ever known in terms of thoughts and beliefs toward not only English learning but also life. Working with her helps me believe in myself much more and think of things much more positively.

Moreover, she had good professional background and knowledge in English learning and teaching. She graduated from Chung-Hsin University in Taiwan, majoring in Foreign Literature and Languages. She also got a Master degree in linguistics from a university in US. She initially taught at a university as a part-time instructor for three years; then she taught in the Good-Tiding Bible College. After that, she taught at the Affiliated Experimental High School of Tung-Hai University and then at the National Chin-Yi University of Technology. Along with this impressive pedigree of teaching she also worked at a cram school where one

of her relatives was the shareholder.

After Maggie got married, the government set in place an unprecedented and unrepeated test of all elementary school English teachers as there were the great needs of elementary English teachers eight years ago. She managed to pass and finished this education program, meanwhile; she had a difficult class in her practical training. She managed to influence this troublesome class in terms of discipline and learning so much she reformed them into model “angel” class in the last elementary years before graduation. After that she became a formal English teacher at elementary school for two years. She quit the job as lecturer and cram school teachers as she was too exhausted from juggling her family life with her working commitments.

Her beliefs make her a really positive angel in life-outlook. For example, she takes her job as accompanying students safely across the road as an honorable mission to be accomplished rather than complaining about the early morning start, to arrive at school. Occasionally, I had chance to observe her class and heard her praising her students several times a minute. What a perfect choice I made to invite her to be one angle of my triangulation!

I asked her to comment on the interview scripts of my three language school participant teachers. She wished to share with me about her views on the interviews and provide suggestions. A positive method utilized by my participants could be viewed differently or negatively, depending on that individual’s viewpoints. She is a much older teacher with many

years of life and teaching experiences both as a cram school and formal school teacher. I was therefore hoping for a more objective view from Maggie to any problem encountered.

3.5.2 The Concerns to Ignore Parents' and Students' Perspectives

I do have some careful considerations of how to incorporate students' and parents' opinions in my analysis. Since, it's understandable that people normally tend to suppose there should be parents' and students' opinions as two main angles in the self-esteem enhancement evaluation event to triangulate the teacher's methods, strategies to be appropriate or not. However, there are still some reasons that the parents' and students' perspectives are not appropriately feasible.

The Weakness of Students' Opinions

1. Besides the students' memory may be no longer fresh, or organized, it can also be not longer time enough for learners to recall the memory to understand the meaning of what a teacher did to him/her. For instance, I did not appreciate my own angel teacher in my elementary school life. I even hated her sometimes as I had to memorize extra readings to join competitions. I doubted that "why my other classmates did not have to do so". "It's unfair." I did not understand that she believed me and chose me to be able to do it than others and trained me to be confident to speak in front of others. Not until I grew up, I had chance to compare her with other inappropriate teachers. I started to understand and appreciate her meaning to do a lot of things on me. I did feel somewhat honorable that I represented my class to join speech competition but not dare to share my honorable feeling. So, a student who has just been taught by a teacher or still been teaching by a teacher may not be able to provided meaningful and correctly positive or negative

information. It might tend to be a piece of preference of adjectives.

2. Students may not have enough English teachers to compare. Although, students nowadays tend to have more teachers than in the past but formal school, cram school and care center English teachers are functioned differently to be compared.
3. If it's an undergoing class, it will not be a complete and done case yet to be discussed as the teacher is still in the process of enhancing the learners' self-esteem and English learning facilitating.
4. The selection of a student to be a discussion case by whom according to what is also tricky. Selection by the teacher might be bias but selection by me does not provide better choice as I do not know them. A past case selected by a teacher may be so typically and representatively positive but luckily, the teachers honestly shared unsuccessful cases.
5. There might be a refined method. I could have a teacher choose a totally new class. The teacher teaches the class for couple weeks. The teacher then, chooses several students. I then, have a longer observation for maybe several months or a year. The interview will follow by the teaching and interaction between them. However, it will not be naturally happened in the reality to fit the definition of case study but an on purpose case. And it will still be with the weakness of students' opinions.

The Weakness of Parents' Opinions

1. According to the observation of me and all my participants, parents are not always close to their children. Students do not share with their parents what happened at school very detail but they may only share the positive parts. And, students love to lie to protect themselves. So, it's not easy for a parent to catch the whole, correct picture of the interaction of their child and their teachers. If a teacher assigns something like a speech competition, it may be easier to share as it's a huge event. What if it's only the interaction in class and it's not noted in communication books or homework books, parents won't

know.

2. Culturally, parents in Taiwan tend to notice if a teacher is strict and responsible enough to take care of their children and the self-esteem enhancement is not equally emphasized.
3. Parents' appreciation of and attitudes toward a language or cram school teacher's extra work tends to be different from formal school teachers. For formal school teachers, parents tend to appreciate the teachers' extra work as they think they did not have to pay. Maybe, the formal school teacher will do some extra supports for a student in the morning, lunch or nap period. But, for the language school teachers who parents think they pay for so, they do not appreciate it as they take it for granted. However, the truth is they pay for the normal classes not for the extra making up or helping. The language school teachers do not get extra salary like what a formal school does. There is not time, either. In the time before language or cram school classes, the students are still at formal schools. And, in the time after class, the parents rush the class to finish on time so that they can pick up the kids home earlier.
4. If the researcher wants to interview a parent, it may become a request of a parent's appreciation of his/her kid's teacher, which decreases the appreciation from the parents to this teacher. I do not want this to happen as it hurts my participant teachers.
5. Similar to the students, the parents do not have that many teachers to compare as the supervisor and colleagues can do.

The Advantages of Supervisor's Opinions and Observations

1. Supervisor stands as a special angle as she runs a business. She does not want to lose a customer. A teacher who damage a student's or a parent's self-esteem probably makes the supervisor lose a customer in her business.
2. Supervisor is much more senior to have observed far more teachers and deal with far more cases of students learning problems and self-esteem enhancement events.

3. A supervisor evaluates a teacher's appropriateness on all purposes in terms of self-esteem enhancement rather than on a particular single event to value if a teacher is successful or not to enhance a learner's self-esteem in comparing to parent's or student's perspectives.

The Advantages of Colleagues' Opinions and Observations

1. There is an interesting phenomenon that people tend to look down other people who work in the same career. This may due to a competition nature. However, the advantages for doing research will be that people in the same career will discriminate and appreciate the colleagues more strictly and professionally. They agreed with my choice of the three main participants of their profession in terms of self-esteem enhancement and have not very close relationship besides work with them, which shows their true-hearted agreements with these three successful colleagues with less bias as peers.
2. The colleagues work with my three main participants in the same environment so, they know the difficulties, problems of enhancing learners' self-esteem in this particular context, for example, the appreciation and attitudes things I mentioned in the weakness of parents' opinions. They can provide more information in other conditions, cases happened in this context or in other inappropriate teachers' classes to compare with the three main participants' successful methods and strategies to interact with learners' self-esteem.
3. They not only have chances to observe the three main participants' classes but also had chances to be observed and suggested opinions by the three to enhance their teaching and interaction with learners.

3.6 Data Analysis Method

Narrative Analysis

The collected data included transcripts of the interviews, observation notes of the three

participant teachers. The supervisors' and the colleagues' interviews were also transcribed as well. The participant teachers' transcriptions were firstly divided into positive and negative effects on enhancing self-esteem. Secondly, the transcriptions of strategies, teachers' beliefs and observation notes were analyzed by Narrative Analysis methods to analyze methods of raising self-esteem to relate to relevant literature.

This was a case study research so data and subsequent outcomes were unexpected and various. Narrative analysis fits my study as its stages are as my procedures to my study. There are five stages categorized by Riessman (2004). She called them: "attending to experience", "telling about experience", "transcribing experience", "analyzing experience" and "reading experience".

Riessman (2004) thinks that it's not possible for a researcher to get into another's experience. A researcher is dealing with discourse, interactions, explanations which are vague to some extent. In this case, narrative analysis is a presentation of an experience.

TABLE 4 The Functions and Main Steps of Narrative Analysis

Steps of Experiences	Main Functions
1. Attending to Experience	Recall of Experiences and Feelings
2. Telling about Experience	Interpretation of Participants and Feedback of Researcher
3. Transcribing Experience	Transcription and Re-Interpretation
4. Analyzing Experience	Relation to the Research Questions and After-thought

Many scholars have provided steps for analyzing experiences. Labov (1972), for example, claimed that there are six important elements included in a narrative analysis form. The six elements are firstly abstract, secondly condition which includes time, place, context and participants, thirdly order of factors, fourthly value which includes the significance and meaning of a factor and fifthly the attitude toward them of the narrator, sixthly solutions which mean what happened in the end and the result.

The other is Gee (1991) who highlighted the change, hesitation of intonation in the oral part of the analyzed discourse. The change and hesitation also emphasized the analyzer's value in common. They shared that the analyzer will create a new story version of the original. The value of the new version is the perspective and interaction between the analyzer and the story and the story participants and the narrator. In my data analysis, I incorporated these important elements of these analysis methods to analyze and present my data. (See Appendix D for an example.)

In Taiwan, Lin (2004) had done a study by interviewing students and did narrative analysis to the transcription. In her research, she represented the students' feelings vividly as if she was the students. I am going to present my participants' experiences, as if I was involved in their situations while dealing with students' self-esteem and other issues.

CHAPTER FOUR

DATA ANALYSIS – ONE

THE ANGEL TEACHERS' CASES AND PHILOSOPHY

This chapter presents the data analysis of the transcriptions of the interview of my main three participant teachers, i.e., Charlotte, Pevin and Anne. They shared one to two students' learning stories mostly including the interactions, parents and peers. After sharing students' stories, they shared their philosophies in relation to self-esteem and English learning. In Chapter Four and Five, I gave some small titles to hint the contents of followed paragraphs or a paragraph to make it easier comprehensive as it's the much longer sections in comparing to other chapters. The table below shows what my data consist of and what I have done in this research.

TABLE 5 The Data Contents

Data	The Contents	Teachers or students included
Students of Stories	-4 learners	Robin, Vito, Jimmy, Jack
Recording of interview (Main participants and triangulation	-7 shares	Charlotte, Pevin, Anne, Frances, Evtia, Sharon and Maggie (in the order of interview recording)

participants)		
Transcription (Main participants and triangulation participants)	-15 pieces (4 stories portions, 7 philosophies portions and 4 perspectives portions) -Around 4000 to 6000 words of each one	-Stories: Robin, Vito, Jimmy, Jack -Philosophies: Charlotte, Pevin, Anne, Frances, Evtia, Sharon, Maggie -Perspectives: Frances, Evtia, Sharon, Maggie
Observation (Before class, in class and after class period of time)	-27 hours total -9 classes -9 times -3 times of each teacher -3 classes of each teacher in classes: -18 teaching hours total -6 hours of each teacher's teaching before or after classes: -9 hours total -1 hour each class -30 minutes before and after each	Charlotte, Pevin and Anne's high, intermediate and low level classes in different branches of the language institute in Taichung City

	class's interaction of teachers and students	
Recording of teaching (Before class, in class and after class period of time)	-9 recordings -9 classes -1 teacher with 3 classes -3 teachers with 9 classes -1 class recorded 3 hours -27 hours total	Charlotte, Pevin and Anne's high, intermediate and low level classes in different branches of the language institute in Taichung City

4.1 Teacher Charlotte and Robin

Teacher Charlotte shared a stuttering student named Robin, as this student is the most impressing and touching one in her teaching experience in terms of self-esteem enhancement.

• **Robin's situation:** Robin is a kid with a speech impediment. Speech impediments, or stuttering, according to Yang (2001) have some main characteristics, 'word repetition', 'part-word repetition', 'broken words', 'phrase repetition', 'interjection', 'revision' and 'abandonment'.

• **Robin's mom's preparation:** His mother planned to take him to learn English. Robin's mom wanted him to overcome his weakness but she was also worried. She expected so much from his language learning and told Robin that learning English would be fun and interesting. She encouraged Robin to be curious about English and wanted him to try to learn it. She built

up Robin's confidence by telling him that he was more than capable of learning this new subject.

- **My views:** Robin's mom pretty much achieved what Carlson (1988) suggested that parents could achieve this simply by how they speak to their children and results in building self-esteem. Something as simple as, "I can see you have done a good job," would help to fulfill this requirement, so I thought Robin would not doubt his capability!

- **Robin's mom's efforts:** So Robin's mom took Robin to our language school and it so happened that it was a new class of teacher Charlotte. Robin's mom asked the secretary if she could speak to the teacher beforehand so that the teacher might be more prepared and understandable of Robin's background better before teaching him. Robin's mom said, "Dear teacher Charlotte, my son has a speech impediment and may be a burden for you. I'm pretty sorry about that, but please try not to discourage him from speaking as he has already been hurt at his formal school by his teachers and mates."

- **My views:** In Christopher's (2006) classification of research findings on parenting styles, the "effective self esteem enhancing techniques" section includes, "the importance of being accepting and caring". Robin's mom actively reinforced this by informing Charlotte of the situation and requesting "acceptance" of her son and "caring" for his needs.

- **Charlotte's appreciation:** Teacher Charlotte felt such warmth toward Robin's mom that she said, "I would have done something inappropriate if I hadn't reminded myself who Robin was!" I think his mom had great influence on him and has educated him so

positively.” “A teacher has to face so many students that she needs some time to figure out each student’s specialty, personalities and possible weaknesses which may require help.”

“I am a humorous teacher who likes to tease myself and my learners to make a lesson as much fun as possible. It could be fun for all common students but if a learner is disabled in some way he/she may feel quite sensitive to such comments, and misinterpret them as if the teacher is trying to hurt them on purpose. This kind of damage might not be remedied in time and cause a negative image in the student’s mind.” Charlotte explained thankfully.

• **My views:** Take myself as an example; I once had a pretty short hair cut when I was an elementary school student. A music teacher laughed at me and thought I was a boy. This incident stayed with me for years and hurt me until I was somewhat mature enough to reject her impolite joke about me.

• **Robin’s beginning learning:** Parents like Robin’s mom are brave to face their problems and thoughtful enough to help teachers a lot in this kind of situation. However, it did not initially prevent the students in Robin’s class teasing him about his speech impediment. In the very beginning, Robin was very nervous when he had to answer Charlotte’s questions or when he was trying to perform better, so much so that his speech impediment became more obvious and serious.

• **My views:** Wingate (2002) classified speech impediment, or stuttering, into three parts. One part is related to emotions. “People with a speech impediment present a particular emotional state... like being afraid, shamed, nervous or angry.”

• **Charlotte's solutions:** Robin's mates would laugh at him because they thought it was funny whilst others would laugh ironically. Charlotte angrily stopped the naughty students and made them apologize to Robin right away. Charlotte encouraged Robin the way she praised other students. In addition, she encouraged him when she realized that he might need some extra incentive to go on without waiting too long. Charlotte informed Robin that he was trying so hard and doing so well, speaking to him during class time and in person after class.

• **My views:** As a learner and a teacher, I have felt and observed that when a student is praised by a teacher in front of classmates or apologized by mates, he/she can sometimes feel a bit embarrassed or pretend that he/she doesn't care, as he/she is not sure if he/she deserves it. However, depending on the individual, they may feel like they are being praised by the whole class and feel more comfortable and confident, and then accepting that praise. In my experience, if a teacher praised me privately, I would sense that I had great relationship with this teacher and would try harder to keep up this interaction by performing better.

• **Robin's improving:** Robin then started to trust Charlotte enough to put his hands up to answer questions that Charlotte was actually asking other students to answer. This seems to reveal that he had started to practice at home so that he was confident of his answers.

• **My views:** Tseng (2003) suggested that elementary teachers should build up the sense of trust between teachers and learners to facilitate learning efficiency as students might go for help from the teachers who they trust to solve their problems.

Robin was very nervous to speak in front of people both mentally and physically.

Charlotte admired his courage and praised him right after he tried to answer, whether the answer was right or wrong. Charlotte knew that he must have practiced so many times at home with the CD, so that he dared to put his hands up to answer the questions and overcome his fear that he might be laughed at.

The longer he learned English in Charlotte's class the better he answered the questions. His passion and patience to work hard on learning English facilitated his learning a lot. Robin's classmates got used to his speech impediment and ignored it so that he was permitted enough time to try to speak as fluently as possible and finish a whole sentence.

• **My views:** I think his classmates have also been taught a valuable social lesson on how to get along with students who have speech impediments and also the acceptance of others.

• **Recording assignment miracle:** There is an assignment called recording homework, and this involves students recording English paragraphs to tape at home. Charlotte was happily grading everyone's recording assignment when she saw Robin's name on the tape. She had prepared herself with the thought that this one might not be okay. However, it was extremely extraordinary and outstanding in terms of fluency, accent, accuracy, intonation and tone! Charlotte was shocked and double-checked if she had seen the name on the tape correctly. Yes, it was definitely right that it was Robin's tape. She re-listened several times and was pretty sure that it was his voice. Charlotte taught herself a lesson, that a person with a speech impediment may have trouble speaking fluently in front of people but might be fine to speak to a machine.

• **My views:** Lin (2005) had researched the relationship between anxiety and stuttering. She obtained results showing that a speaker in a recording condition suffers higher anxiety than in a monologue condition. In Robin's case, speaking to Charlotte and the class appeared more similar to a recording situation than actually doing a recording assignment by himself at home (therefore emulating a monologue condition.)

• **Honorable moment:** The next lesson, Charlotte praised him in class, she said, "There are some students who did the recording homework super well. They are Robin, so and so." Moreover, she played the tapes for the class. Robin's was played last because his was the best. Everyone was surprised and admired Robin. They looked at him as if he was a hero. Charlotte could see in Robin's eyes that he was so touched and proud. Charlotte was also encouraged that Robin liked English.

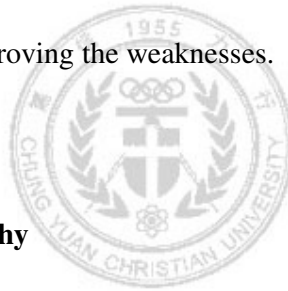
• **My views:** Yang (2001) had conducted research that showed students with a stutter or a speech impediment did not always have a negative influence on their self-esteem. A kindergarten student once said, "When I can't say it, I will say it bravely."

• **Speech performance:** After this wonderful experience, Charlotte decided to have Robin give a speech on performance day for parents. Robin felt so pressured and was trying to communicate with Charlotte that he would like to give up. Charlotte stayed after class to practice with him and encouraged him saying that he was capable of doing this. Practice may not make "perfect", but it did help.

On performance day, Robin performed much better in front of the whole class and their

parents than he did with Charlotte. Charlotte told him that he kind of overcame his speech impediment and that he was not as nervous to speak in front of an audience as he thought. Robin's mom was so moved that she couldn't speak but had tears in eyes after her son finished that speech which was called, "My mom".

- **My views:** As mentioned in the literature, Frey and Carlock's (1989) "Eclectic Variations on a Humanistic Theme" requires teachers or parents to focus on the co-existence of the value of an individual's weaknesses and strengths. Charlotte realized both Robin's weaknesses and strengths, and figured out a better way to enhance Robin's self-esteem by encouraging the strengths and improving the weaknesses.



4.2 Teacher Charlotte's Philosophy

In this section, Charlotte shared her thoughts toward Robin's case and her own experience and ideas of self-esteem.

- **Self-esteem & obstacle:** Charlotte thought that Robin's self-esteem and his English both improved and they enhanced each other's self-esteem. "The higher a student's self-esteem is, the better he/she can overcome his/her obstacles," Charlotte claimed. "A student's self-esteem enables him/her to conquer their difficulties. After they break through their difficulties, their self-esteem increases. Then, they have more power to bridge over the next barrier."

- **External assistant:** Teacher Charlotte believes that self-esteem is from external factors

or others and the environment that places a value onto an individual. She explained that there can be an individual whose self-esteem is high, but once others look down on him or her, or much lower than he or she values them, their self-esteem can be harmed.

- **Adults & children:** Charlotte also compared the differences between adults and children. She considers that an adult might be more capable of esteeming themselves higher or lower to maintain his or her well-being. In contrast, a child may not be cognitively aware of his or her self-esteem so whenever an adult values him or her, they may think that's what they are or what they should be. More significantly, Charlotte emphasized that a kid may not know, or forget, how good they are if no one reminds or informs them.

- **Speaking & self-esteem:** As for the interaction of learning English and self-esteem, Charlotte stated the importance of learning how to speak the language. For Charlotte, "learning English is learning how to speak it mostly". She took adults for example. In her adult class, "there can be people who score highly in writing and reading exams but relatively lower in speaking". She thinks adults' self-esteem with regards to their pronunciation and accent seriously affects their willingness to speak out.

- **My views:** I assume that these adults may have been teased or laughed at about their speaking abilities either by the actual sound of the words or by facial expressions of fellow listeners, so that they have already judged themselves as being incapable of speaking English. Or, they might not have had chance to confirm their own speaking abilities. Consequently, they shy away from learning how to speak but emphasize learning other parts of English to

compensate.

- **Speaking needs better guts:** Charlotte has observed that, “people with more guts, relatively learn speaking better and quicker, as well as people who possess more positive thinking towards learning”. “Mostly, self-esteem seems to affect their ability to learn English speech very much.”

- **Benefit of children’s lower awareness of self-esteem:** For children, Charlotte thinks that it’s lucky that kids’ own self-esteem awareness is much lower than in adults. They can be more flexible and adaptive when learning to speak another language. They do not care about ‘face’ as much as an adult does. They are not so afraid of trying hard and less aware of their self-esteem being hurt as adults may be. However, they still need encouragement to speak out because others will hear their speeches, just like the adults. Charlotte concluded that “speaking requires a great deal of self-esteem build-up to be facilitated fully.”

- **Charlotte’s learning experience: a Chinese teacher:** In Charlotte’s own learning experience, there was a Chinese teacher who did similar things for her as she did in Robin’s case. She liked writing essays very much when she was a senior high school student. The Chinese teacher observed and recognised her writing abilities and told her that she was really good at it. This encouraged Charlotte and she liked writing more and has kept writing little essays and diaries right up until now. Charlotte thanked this Chinese teacher for informing her that she had this talent and has enjoyed it ever since. Even now this experience still effects her somewhat especially as she became a teacher herself.

• **Challenges for Charlotte:** Regardless of these positive experiences, Charlotte honestly admitted that, “teaching all comers without discrimination,” like Confucian, “to protect all learners’ self-esteem is pretty impossible for her.” She understands that teachers are also human beings who may prefer smart, sweet, nice and well-educated learners. Teachers have their own emotions for sure. “When a quite naughty student does not do whatever he/she should to finish work that you assigned them and or displays the attitude that it’s not a big deal, these do piss off the teachers,” Charlotte described. “It’s super easy to enhance a good learners’ self-esteem; meanwhile, it’s super hard to enhance a lazy, naughty or troublesome learner’s self-esteem”. These latter students require more of the teachers’ patience and time to maybe enhance their relatively low self-esteem. These are definitely a challenge for teachers.

Therefore, she found that she does need to become introspective with herself sometimes and remind herself how her teacher patiently encouraged her and to act like that herself with her own students. Charlotte felt that this part of her teaching she had refined the most and achieved a lot in the way she interacts with her students.

• **A hopeless case:** Recently, she encountered what appeared to be a pretty hopeless case in which Charlotte thought she might lose control and damage the student’s self-esteem. This student performed pretty badly both in homework and tests. She cried when Charlotte tried communicating with her. Charlotte spent a lot of extra out-of-class time to support her. It appeared that the student knew where she had gone wrong and that she had to improve.

However, it happened again and again and these instances did make Charlotte want to give up on this learner occasionally.

• **Parents' responsibility:** In Charlotte's observations, she found that this kind of case seemed to happen with children with similar types of parents, who tended to spoil their children. "These kind of parents may or may not tell their kids what they did was wrong and what they should do to make it right, but there isn't any kind of follow-up strategy or solution when their children do not achieve or obey the previous deal," Charlotte proficiently expressed. "Consequently, their children believe it's not such a big deal to not follow their parents' directions. Even they figure out that they can manipulate their parents in this un-cooperative method."

• **My view:** I assume that this kind of learners' self-esteem might not be too high either as they don't have much chance of experiencing any sense of achievement by being able to master a skill or learning a subject by overcoming their own difficulties.

• **Individual difference observed by Charlotte:** Charlotte, moreover, described that there is huge difference in learners' self-esteem. "Some student's self-esteem may be so weak that if you tell them something about where they went wrong, they will feel such extreme shame that right away they correct it to win your agreement back to rebuild their self-esteem as soon as possible. Others may not be so sensitive to their teachers or parent's advice and they require other methods of teaching to be taught effectively. This may have been because their teachers or parents may not have punished them or taken away their rewards when they

have not behaved well.”

- **Rewards and punishments:** To dispense with reward and punishment impartially is necessary for Charlotte. She thinks that it’s also necessary for parents and teachers to better direct students learning and social behavior this way.

- **My view:** I agree that dispensing reward and punishment impartially is important in building self-esteem as a learner has a better chance of mastering a skill successfully and positively by being rewarded.

- **Parents’ missed appointment:** Charlotte emphasized that “not conducive kind of parenting style does get Charlotte down a lot, which in turn decreases Charlotte’s self-esteem.” This kind of parenting can obstruct Charlotte a great deal to an extent that she feels it’s hard to keep on facilitating the learners’ English learning and to avoid damaging the learner’s self-esteem. Pathetically, these kinds of learner’s own parents are pretty similar to their children. Charlotte described that “they promise their child’s teacher that they will co-operate with the teacher, to urge their child to study harder etc., but both of them fail to achieve this and fulfil their part of the bargain.” Both parents and children seem to be emulating and reinforcing the unhelpful behaviour. This seems to reveal that both the learner and their parents’ suffer from low self-esteem, as this type of assignment achievement can create huge pressure in their lives.

- **The right things to do:** Charlotte said that “she has faced these depressing situations for years but she still manages to keep her patience and passion for some reasons.” She

considers that being honest is still the most important thing in teaching even though business is the main goal rather than education in a language or cram school. When she encounters parents or learners with relatively conflicting thoughts towards learning, she professionally and patiently tries to explain why they might encounter problems in learning a subject well.

- **My view:** I agree with her and her working ethics, as these parents may not be able to accept what we try to inform them now; but they may realize in the future that we were trying to help them and their children to improve their learning and enhance their self-esteem.

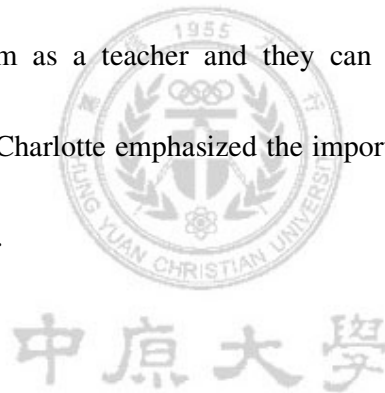
- **Learning English is like learning a melody:** Charlotte shared her way to encourage parents to have their kids form the habit of listening to language material CDs at home which can help facilitate learning language speaking. The CD contains the same material as the textbooks so that the learners can listen to them at home and maintain the listening environment and continue to learn. She tells the parents that, “It’s similar to listening to music. Regardless of some special melodies that make people remember easier, we may be able to listen to a melody but not be able to sing the melody until we have listened to it many times. A piano player can figure out and recognize each musical note from a melody as she or he has already been familiar with each sound and tone.”

- **My view:** This kind of explanation can easily and quickly get parents to understand the importance of listening, in terms of learning speaking, that they would probably be more willing to ask their children to listen to these CD’s out of class. This may not only enhance their learning efficiency and subsequently their self-esteem but also ensure more parent

understanding and participation.

- **Work on cooperation:** She believes that she can make progress with students when she is allowed to make such efforts. As long as the parents co-operate and the learners have tried their best to learn, there will be successful outcomes in learning. Moreover, there are so many lovely students and parents who appreciate her hard-work and help facilitate her teaching and enhance her own self-esteem that she insists that she will not give in to the depressions and keep going on.

To sum up, Charlotte appreciates the hard-working students and parents very much as they enhanced her self-esteem as a teacher and they can encourage her to conquer the troublesome ones. Moreover, Charlotte emphasized the importance of self-esteem in learning English especially in speaking.



4.3 Teacher Pevin and Vito

Teacher Pevin shared a problematic student named Vito as he is the most challenged one in terms of behavior discipline in her teaching experience.

- **Vito's situation:** Vito had been taught by Pevin for about a year in his second grade period. He was originally in another class, which had been split partly into teacher Pevin's class. Vito's first teacher had informed Pevin about some behavioral problems that he exhibited and that he was not easy to control in class.

Vito could be really naughty and/or try to affect other students in class. He didn't

concentrate on learning sometimes and importantly there didn't seem to be any clear or regular pattern to his naughty behavior. For example, he would turn around to bother his classmates, or he would sit under the table or even lie down on the ground. He would want to talk to his classmates or tease them while he was turning to face the back of the classroom. Vito didn't sit on the ground while Teacher Pevin was teaching him but he did when the native speaker teacher was teaching him. He didn't obey Pevin's or the native speaking teacher's commands to get up back to his seat for about thirty minutes once. Pevin finally asked him to get out of the classroom and communicated with him about what had just happened.

• **Vito's problem and family members:** According to Pevin's experiences of dealing with numerous behavioral troublesome students, Pevin assumed his behavior problems might not be related to learning but from something else. She mentioned his family members. Vito's father was a taxi driver who worked at night and his mom was a foreign bride from mainland China. His mom also worked every day as well and was unable to accompany him. Vito is the only son of this family. In telephone tests, Pevin could tell from conversations with Vito's mom that she was not able to discipline Vito. In the telephone tests, Vito's mom politely asked Pevin about any areas that his learning required more practice and that she would inform his dad. She basically implied that Vito didn't listen to her words a lot. As for Vito's dad, he would discipline Vito so that Vito would be afraid of him and then follow his commands.

• **My view:** Chen (2004) had research on school life adjustment for foreign brides' children. She found that school life adaptabilities of children including peering relations are higher than learning performance, which seemed to be the opposite of Vito's situation.

• **Vito's scary statement:** Pevin sadly shared that "after she taught him for about six months, his behavioral problems seemed to have gotten worse and worse." "Vito's statements scared Pevin seriously because Vito would say things like, "I don't want to be alive anymore". "I want to die." "Being alive is meaningless". In his second grade period, his words did shake Pevin very much. Pevin asked him what had happened, to make him feel so hopeless. Vito said directly that, "classmates in this language school hate me, classmates in formal school hate me and classmates in day care center hate me." Due to this conversation, Pevin realized that some of his mood problems might stem mostly from social relationships and related issues.

• **Vito's excellent English learning:** Surprisingly, Pevin said "his English learning was not problematic at all." Pevin even considered him a pretty smart student. Pevin had some interesting interactions and experiences with him that seemed to suggest that he was not rigid in his thought processes. He would think of other ideas that were related to the topic Pevin was discussing with the class. He was also capable of asking lateral questions, which suggested seeing the topic of discussion from different viewpoints. His responses and reactions were so positive and creative. He was even very smart at learning grammar points, as he didn't make the same grammar mistake twice. Vito easily picked up what Pevin had

taught him to apply to other new sentences quickly. His speaking, reading, writing and listening performance were easily good enough to pass each level. His assignment work and grades were also brilliant.

• **Vito's unstable performance:** In fact there was only one situation that Pevin can recall during teaching him English that he didn't have his assignment completed. However, he would write his assignment super ugly when he was in bad mood. He would merely meet the teacher's absolute basic requirements to have the assignment done in these kinds of situations. This kind of deliberate negative performance, which was affected by his mood, happened in his telephone tests as well. He would be unwilling to answer teacher's questions while he was not happy but not because he was unable to answer them. Vito might not have been the only problematic student Pevin has had to deal with but such experiences have helped her cope more and more professionally in teaching.

• **Vito's peers:** In this class, the students did not like Vito very much as he would tease others or be naughty and so affect their learning. Once while Vito was absent, the whole class seemed to be more relaxed and happy. When Vito did show up, the whole class yelled, "Oh!" to express how much they did not want to learn with him, which made Pevin so embarrassed. Similar situations have happened in my class as well.

• **My view:** There might be some students being teased in some ways but I won't allow it. I definitely stop it and ask students to apologize to the one they have teased straight away and also ask the subject of the teasing if they are okay.

• **Vito's dad's absence:** Vito's dad rarely communicated with Pevin. Most of the time it was Vito's mom who interacted with teachers whether by phone or in person with Pevin, his formal school teachers or the teacher in the after-school child care school.

• **Other teachers' view:** To sum up his ability to learn, Vito's teachers thought his learning performance was not stable. He could perform pretty well in every way and earn teachers' praise and encouragement and feel pretty good about himself sometimes, but then his mood would turn and he appeared to become an evil negative student almost instantaneously.

• **Vito's school time:** Teacher Pevin tried to communicate with Vito's mom to figure out exactly what was the problem emotionally that affected his learning so much. However, she didn't get precise, concise answers from Vito's mom, as Vito stays in his after-school child care center for a really long time every day virtually till he goes home to merely sleep. This information left Pevin with the understanding that his emotional problems were probably due to a lack of important interactive social relationships.

• **My view:** Firstly, and paramount, with his parents and then at every other stage, his formal school, his language school and his after school care center. He was a student who was capable of learning and probably processed a stable or relatively high self-esteem with regards to learning, including English, but much lower in social relationships or people skills. Lu (2004) had research on school life adjustment for foreign brides' children as well. She found foreign brides trust and rely on tutor teachers highly but foreign brides' children had more

peering difficulties and more learning problems.

- **Pevin's accompany:** During the period Pevin taught him, for almost a year, Vito's learning performance was extremely stable and outstanding. Pevin encouraged him in person, and during telephone tests, with his mom and it did last for some time. Pevin said, "He is really good sometimes and really bad sometimes." When his performance was falling, teacher Pevin would enquire about his bad moods and ask for the reasons. Apart from the dramatic ones was Vito wanted to end his life, he usually answered that there was nothing special for them. He merely felt powerless and didn't want to do anything. He was not always able to express himself fully about his sadness.

Pevin realized that he might change his behavior or try to improve his learning because of a teachers' genuine encouragement or reminding him his mood sometimes but it wouldn't last too long. As Vito mostly stayed in his after school care center till about ten o'clock, Pevin assume his parent's absence and school social relationship problems affected his self-esteem the most.

- **Dad's presence:** At the end of the teaching level, there was a class performance presentation that invited parents to come along. Pevin surprisingly saw Vito's dad present. Pevin observed that his dad looked at Vito with hope, love and tears in his eyes. Pevin realized that this family loved each other very much but they unfortunately lacked the time and opportunities to share their life together.

In conclusion, Pevin was challenged by Vito very much and tried her best to understand

the problem of this learner and his family and realized his self-esteem problem step by step. Pevin concluded that “this could be an exhausting but insightful experience for teachers to considerate while dealing with students’ learning and peering social self-esteem.

4.4 Teacher Pevin and Jimmy

Pevin shared another student named Jimmy as her most interesting discovery that a learner’s learning outcome can improve so dramatically.

- **Jimmy’s lack of confidence:** Jimmy was another student of Pevin’s in a class that she taught for four years. He was a very polite and unconfident student. He always obeyed teacher Pevin with extreme politeness answering questions as if he was ashamed of his answers.

- **Jimmy’s learning difficulties and Pevin’s solutions:** In the first year Jimmy was only seven years old and in his first grade period. The learning material was relatively simple and easy to learn so there wasn’t any huge difference between his learning and others. After Jimmy entered in his third grade; however, he started to encounter problems and submitted poorly written assignments.

Pevin started to ask him to stay after class to review the questions and to explain to her why a particular answer was correct or incorrect to see if he’d truly understood what he had just learnt. After these interactions his learning did improve and his assignments achieved much higher grades. In comparison, Jimmy was not as good as his other classmates in this class. Pevin did however mention that the students in that class were relatively outstanding

with regards to other classes.

Jimmy's grammar was confused and the problem got worse and worse when he entered the intermediate high school level of this language. In this level, the reading and pattern material is about the present participle tense. Pevin recommended that he attend a theme-based class called, 'grammar fun', which would review and preview grammar and patterns for him. Jimmy found this very helpful and it cleared up some of his grammar misunderstandings.

Moreover, there was also a system, known as K.K. at this level, where he also struggled. Pevin asked him to stay after class to review the taught K.K. symbols with him several times. After these extra interactions, he improved a lot both in grammar and in the use of the K.K. system.

Pevin felt that he was capable of answering any questions about these subjects no matter how hard they were. Pevin realized that Jimmy might just need more time and practice to learn the new material which is relatively packed into the curriculum compared to other school systems.

- **Crowded material packages and self-esteem:** Pevin compared the material in this language school with other systems and found that the material in this language school is relatively intensive compared to others. There isn't too much time or emphasis on reviewing portions in the new lesson of the last lesson taught which requires a student to work pretty hard to keep up. For a relative slow student, he/she might require more time to digest the

material to be familiar with what he/she had learnt.

- **My view:** Due to this, a slow student such as Jimmy might believe he/she is more incapable than the others and this may affect his/her self-esteem and his/her learning outcome.

He was a student with pretty low class participation, who silently sat in the class and didn't dare to raise his hand. He didn't put himself forward very much as he perceived himself weak in most areas including reading, speaking, listening or writing.

- **Turning point – Jimmy's successful role play:** Apart from the grammar fun class and K.K. improvement in the intermediate high level, Jimmy showed an extraordinary ability which both surprised his mates and Pevin. At this intermediate high level, he performed the conversation section extremely well. His tone, intonation was so clear, vivid and dramatic, that he appeared to like to act and he even added gestures into the conversation. He seemed to be very comfortable in playing his role.

Pevin praised his great acting skill in the next telephone test and stated that he'd played his role so well. Pevin said that, "You not only performed very well but you also memorized all the contents". Pevin found that Jimmy had worked very hard to memorize the whole contents of the conversation so that he could feel quite comfortable when performing it. Additionally, he had added his own thoughts and words to the conversation, which enhanced it and made Pevin realize just how well he had really acted.

After Pevin mentioned all this in his telephone test, she found Jimmy more comfortable and active in class. Pevin thinks that this was a really special achievement as the conversation

in the intermediate high level is not easy and sometimes relatively boring. Jimmy was not always good at conversation sections in class and he made a huge step ahead at that level.

- **Comic attraction:** Conversation material in this intermediate-high level is presented in a comic story way. Pevin assumed that comic stories impacted Jimmy more dramatically than dry pattern material and they sparked Jimmy's interest at this young age. He played his role so vividly in front of his classmates and parents without a hint of nerves that it had obviously captured his imagination.

- **My view:** Jimmy's mastering of comic-book type material reminded me of CALP (cognitive/academic language proficiency) and BICS (basic interpersonal communicative skills) by James Cummins (1979, 1980). CALP is what learners do in their tests for so-called surface features of language rather than being able to make use of language's function to communicate in daily life. Jimmy learned comic-book type material much better in this format because it provided him with a meaningful context he could relate to and communicate in, rather than just trying to learn the grammar or vocabulary of it.

- **Jimmy's self-esteem improved:** After his unbelievable performance, he earned the teacher's and his classmates' acknowledgements and appreciation so much that it made him much more active in class. He interacted more with his classmates and teacher Pevin with regards to his learning. He was already, a friendly and popular classmate even before his great work, but, "his degree of self-esteem did improve dramatically after he did the comic drama so well", Pevin emphasized.

To sum up, Jimmy' English learning and self-esteem were enhanced so much thanks to his hard-working and Pevin's extra work. Pevin thought "being more patient and hopeful to trust a student makes her see the impossible improvement".

4.5 Teacher Pevin's Philosophy

• **English specialty and challenge of speaking:** Pevin shared her ideas about the specialties and connections between English and self-esteem. She compared the differences between learning math and English, as she is an excellent math student herself. In math, she feels more comfortable because she feels it's a private subject between the brain expressing workings and results on paper. In contrast, learning English requires speaking aloud usually to other listeners.

Pevin observed that, "If a student doesn't think he/she is good enough to achieve the task of speaking aloud or he/she thinks the percentages of being successful are low, he/she will not even try to speak." Pevin stated that, "Reading passages aloud is easier as they do not need to express themselves so much, just read out loud what words are written in front of them. Speaking requires a lot more self-esteem than other subjects relatively," Pevin concluded. "It will really be more of a challenge for a student with lower self-esteem to learn to speak a foreign language well." These statements pretty much reflect teacher Charlotte's ideas on learning speaking that "speaking requires more guts".

• **Individual difference observed by Pevin:** As for the methods and attitudes regarding

encouragement and punishment to enhance self-esteem, Pevin figured out there are huge individual differences. “Some students might improve more and more with teachers’ praises and encouragements but others might think teachers are merely saying the words insincerely. Others might think that it doesn’t matter how poorly they perform the teacher will still think they are okay.” Charlotte did mention these individual differences as well.

• **More encouragements:** Pevin still prefers encouragements rather than punishments to induce and direct students’ learning. Pevin’s rationale is that, “Everyone loves to be praised, while one is being praised; this individual wants to act better. And if I act better, I will earn even more praise next time.” Pevin thinks parents’, peers’ and teachers’ encouragements are meditative reasons for learners to perform better.

• **Vito as a negative example:** Pevin recalled Vito’s example that the student thought he was bad so he naturally thought that everyone else thought he wasn’t good, which is almost like a “self-fulfilling prophecy”. So, Pevin thinks that there wasn’t any motivation for him to perform better as he had already decided that he had been labeled as bad. Pevin knew that Vito was a kid who lacked attention from others, so his poor behavior would be a way of gaining attention, even if that were negative attention. She would, therefore, depending on the situation, ignore him sometimes if his behavior did not affect others.

• **Teachers’ power and praise conditions:** Pevin thinks teachers have a powerful influence on their learners, although there are some difficult cases. “Most students hope to earn the teachers’ praise regardless of some exceptions.” Pevin mentioned a parent’s quote,

which stated that, “Praise from a teacher is twenty times more useful than a parent’s one”. In addition, “If a teacher praises a student in front of the whole class, the affect could be even higher than giving it in private”, Pevin cheerfully made this point and this also matches one of Charlotte’s ideas as well.

• **Pevin’s learning – a tough college teacher:** In Pevin’s own learning experiences, one of her college teachers enhanced her self-esteem a lot by assigning her pretty hard work for her to achieve. She was once asked and expected to search a huge amount of literature to support her ideas in a report to be given to her classmates at the end of their semester.

She thinks that this type of assignment was so different from the usual educational style ones used in Taiwan. Usually students seem to learn to answer questions from their teachers without actually thinking for themselves. Pevin found she progressed a lot and learnt more in completing this assignment and that she was more than capable of achieving it. Even though it was a new way of achieving things and hard work for her, she experienced a great sense of achievement.

Every classmate had their own topic so they couldn’t help each other. All the literature and information was found and researched by her instead of being assigned by the professor. This allowed her to think independently. She didn’t consider this teacher to be lazy, as this professor had to read the literature she found as well. Pevin thinks this professor, “Not only assigned them to do a huge task but also joined them in the process”.

• **Pevin’s application:** Pevin has applied this teacher’s philosophy in her own teaching to

extend material content and relate materials to the daily news or hot topics students may be interested in. Again this may give them something to be interested in and allow them a chance to think independently. This does seem to make her classes a lot more interesting for the students and allows them to practice speaking and discuss in class in their groups the related subject matter. Pevin found that, “They were a lot more interested in the material and had a higher motivation to learn”.

- **My view:** I agree with this approach and also the reasons that students felt more capable of understanding teacher Pevin. I think their learning may have improved as these topics were not only interesting but also comprehensive as they might have discussed them already and understood them in their mother tongue.

- **Colleagues’ support for Pevin:** Besides her college professor, she has gained some of her teaching philosophy from some of her colleagues. She thinks that while a teacher is dealing with a learner, there is always something new to learn. Pevin feels that, “Her colleagues are not only her friends but also her own teachers who support her in learning faster and smarter ways in how to teach or communicate with her students”. She thinks, “Her faith in being a teacher has been greatly encouraged and influenced by her colleagues”.

- **Challenges for Pevin and right things to do:** Pevin thinks that working in a language school, does mean that a student’s problem might affect business issues. However, she thinks that, “Insisting that the primary role of a teacher as a learning facilitator is still the most important thing”. Pevin said, “A teacher won’t know if they will affect a learner or not. A

teacher might make a careless mistake and make a student feel hurt enough to even give up learning English or hate it. This kind of damage to someone's self-esteem does have a great impact on a learner." Pevin admitted that, "It's really hard to avoid damaging a student's self esteem sometimes especially if he/she is being naughty. It's easy for Pevin to yell at the naughty ones in front of the whole class. This type of action can damage a learner the most." Charlotte mentioned these types of difficulties for teachers as well.

This kind of situation did happen and, "Pevin felt quite sorry and regretful afterwards". Reasons that may have caused this reaction from Pevin could include her busy teaching schedule, the great amount of material she is expected to deliver in a limit period of time and the lack of time. This limited time doesn't allow dealing with extra problems. Pevin thinks a better solution could be taking the student out of the classroom to communicate with him/her rather than yelling at him/her in front of everyone.

• **My view:** I found this corresponds to the concept of praise as a much more useful tool than punishment when delivered in front of a class. I guess that not only do students, but also teachers, want to be praised and earn positive attention and acknowledgements from everyone and not to be blamed for perceived problems in front of everybody.

In conclusion, Pevin shares some ideas with Charlotte about the effects of teachers' praise and punishments. Pevin emphasizes more on praise and gives students more opportunities to learn by themselves to enhance self-esteem more sufficiently.

4.6 Teacher Anne and Jack

Teacher Anne shared a lazy student named Jack who Anne had most after-class interactions. Anne thought she had hurt and also enhanced his self-esteem the most among students.

• **Jack's situation and the interaction with Anne:** Jack started to learn English in this language school when he was in his third grade period. Teacher Anne was his first teacher, who taught him for about fifteen months. He was a lazy student rather than a learner without interest. The impressive interaction between them happened after class in teacher Anne's memory. She had to encourage him to work harder and informed him that he was capable of improving a great deal more if he committed himself whole-heartedly. Sometimes if Anne was more serious with him, Jack looked like he was going to cry. However, these interactions didn't seem sufficient enough to enhance his learning or self-esteem consistently. He would be better for a while and then return to being lazy again soon after so that Anne had to continuously encourage him over and over again. Anne spent quite a lot of extra hours after class time communicating with Jack and tried to push him to make a greater effort with his learning.

A similar situation, as discussed earlier, (like in Jimmy's class) existed in that Jack's class was an excellent class so although Jack wasn't exactly slow he appeared relatively average. Teacher Anne didn't want him to feel it was hard to keep up with others, so she encouraged him a lot after class. When Anne spent after class time with him, Anne treated

him differently from the way she treated everyone else in class. She praised him more.

• **Individual difference observed by Anne:** Even though Anne did not praise students in class very often as she thought that there were individual considerations to take account of. Some students behaved so well and were praised as good, but others might have thought that even though he or she wasn't trying hard that they also should earn praise. Anne was very careful to observe these individual differences. Anne thinks that interacting with students individually provides teachers with more chance to praise them sufficiently and appropriately. Charlotte, Pevin and Anne all consider delivering praise precisely and correctly according to individual differences as very important.

• **Jack's lack of confidence and Anne's attitude:** Anne considered that "Jack's overall performance in class seemed to reveal his low self-esteem". Although Anne treated all her students equally seriously in class, Jack was the most nervous one. His legs and hands would both begin to shake while he was reading or answering questions. Anne had thought and considered her requests to him carefully. She considered whether she was being too strict to him or giving him too much pressure. However, Anne tried to keep her attitude the same to everyone and did not treat him any nicer or differently than the others if they failed to achieve any of the expected requirements.

• **Jack's Mom's accompany and support:** A hopeful start occurred and Anne was informed of it when she was communicating with Jack's mom. His mom joyfully shared with Anne the news that Jack seemed to be more stable recently. "He even sings English songs

while he is taking a bath!” Jack’s mom encouraged Anne a lot by informing her of Jack’s English learning progress at home.

Jack’s mom played a helpful role in Jack’s English education. She honestly informed teacher Anne what efforts Jack had or hadn’t made. Anne would inform her that if she wanted to help, she could ask Jack to listen to his English CD’s and make sure that he read aloud with the CD’s at home. Anne found that his mom did cooperate with her to facilitate her son’s learning.

“It’s one of the most significant points that can help a student learn well when the teacher and the parents are cooperating well together.” Anne strongly recommends that parents cooperate and support the teachers to facilitate the students learning to their full potential. She thinks that his mom’s hard work contributed a great deal to Jack’s improvement.

• **Improving and learners’ growth:** Anne explained that,

“As students become more and more mature they start realizing what their responsibilities are while as they are getting older and older. Especially a third grader who is at his most active age is relatively hard to control in terms of learning. If a teacher expects a learner like him to improve right away or suddenly fall in love with English, then they are deluding themselves and over - reacting. I was pretty pleased to see that he didn’t give up and tried hard at home.”

Anne thinks this example of trying hard has been really beneficial for this particular

student.

• **Anne's rebuilding strategy:** Anne communicated with Jack numerous times. Once she said, "Do you want to fail right at the very beginning of English learning?" I consider this was a pretty straightforward question to deliver to a student, in retrospect. Pointing out that he or she hadn't worked hard enough is honest but may have damaged a sensitive learner's self-esteem quite a lot. After Anne delivered this straightforward statement she balanced it by giving him hope as well. Anne promised Jack that, "He wasn't alone in this learning but with all his other classmates as well as teacher Anne, who would really support him".

• **My view:** I, as a student, was encouraged in this way a lot because although I was pretty shy I was also lazy. So, a teacher's words could both encourage me or hurt me a lot. I can deeply understand this kind of students' problem as I did not gain much sense of achievement in learning and didn't form a regular learning habit either. Teachers who did try to encourage me did affect me, but not for long. I would start to study harder as long as I sensed that I needed this knowledge and also that I was able to learn this particular subject well. Therefore, my capability and motivation did interact and vary a lot and often.

• **Jack's in class learning:** Jack is the kind of student who did not spend very much time at home practicing what he had been taught in class. So, when he was in class, he seemed to be very worried about being noticed by Anne and being asked to read or answer questions. Anne might not notice him being lazy because she tried to include everyone.

Jack respected and even seemed to be afraid of Anne quite a bit. Once Anne encouraged

him in class in front of everyone stating, “Jack, you will be able to do this test better this time so don’t worry”. Anne could see the faith on his face and that he believed her that he really could do better this time. Anne thought he still had hope and he at least cared about what the teacher said and was encouraged to some extent.

Jack’s peers liked him very much and played with him in the break time happily. Anne observed that he spoke Chinese so loudly, interestingly and fluently in the break time but he stuttered while talking in English especially with Anne. In order to relieve his nervousness, Anne made use of Jack as the subject matter to make humorous sentences to teach the pattern materials. Everyone, including Jack, thought this was very funny and remembered the patterns so well.

Jack would sometimes tease himself and say that he wouldn’t be able to do well in the test and say “it was too hard” But, Anne would deny his words and bet that he would improve. Anne didn’t know if he could, but would say so. Anne reminded him that, “You can do it well as long as you try to be careful”. Anne would strongly state to him and the rest of the class, “I trust you are capable of it.’ He did do well.

- **Alphabets learning difficulties:** Anne has also discovered that the learning of the letters in the English alphabet is not easy for some kids such as Jack for some reasons. She explained that, “Letters can be seen as a kind of symbol. The strokes of these letter symbols are somewhat similar in some ways. But for some students who lack attention to such detail they can get confused at the very beginning and if they do not review them at home it doesn’t

stay in their memory.

These individual differences could largely influence the whole learning outcome of basic letters right from the start.” This could have a huge negative impact on the self-esteem of a new student, as this is only the beginning of learning English. It could have a dramatic affect on an individual if they fail to achieve the perceived simple mastery of these symbols.

Anne mentioned “the cognitive differences between adults and children that a teacher needs to be empathic and understand why it’s confusing learners, rather than blaming them for slow learning”. “If they can’t understand and grasp the alphabet at the beginning, then this barrier could stall the whole learning English process and therefore the students’ belief and self-esteem in continuing their studies”.

• **My view:** Chang (2006) did research on lower-achieving students and the learning effects on the English alphabet. She conceived some features of material design and teaching methods that could facilitate alphabet learning. “Students require dynamic teaching strategies, colorful presentation, interesting sound effects, instant feedback and competitiveness (pp.92).”

Anne taught letters in a detailed way. For instance, she writes some mistaken letters purposely for students to do corrections on the basis of her observation. With this exercise, students usually make fewer mistakes.

To conclude, Anne emphasized the importance of her role and attitude toward hard-working learning for Jack to form better learning habit to sense the achievement to

enhance self-esteem. Also, she tried to understand the difficulties Jack faced and provided him with some supports to overcome them.

4.7 Teacher Anne's Philosophy

- **Anne's strict style:** Teacher Anne encountered an interesting and touching incident with Jack's class. She actually treated that class pretty strict and seriously. If for instance the whole class behaved poorly she would spend the break time informing them of that. If it were an individual's problem behaviour she would ask the student to stay after class, whoever that student was. She stressed the importance of being fair to everyone. After she was transferred to another branch and did not teach that class for two years, she met the students of that class in a proficiency test held by the language school. Surprisingly touching, the students were asking her to come back to teach them with tears in their eyes.

Anne found that being serious and strict is not such a bad thing and might even be necessary for certain students to learn what is right and wrong. They don't seem to blame the teacher for this but respect the teacher more.

Anne clarified and explained the definition of being strict and serious. "Being able to deliver this attitude in such a way won't upset anyone," she promised. Anne stated that "being strict was not merely directed toward the students but also towards the teachers themselves". "A promise or a request made must be achieved and checked not only with regards the students but also the teacher." "Otherwise students will sense that there are double standards

between what they do and what the teacher does.” Also “punishment and reward need to be administered clearly and transparently”.

- **Anne’s rewarding system:** Anne may punish her students’ poor learning behavior seriously, but she will also reward her students if they are performing well or improving themselves. She would give out either attractive presents or genuine words of praise.

There is a game’s day at each level of this language school. Anne would make good use of it to reward students’ hard work and punish students’ lazy work equally hard. She recalled that when she had to go to another branch and left Jack’s class, she bought spoons with different animals on them for every student. This surprised them a great deal as they were not able to imagine that teacher Anne would be so nice to them.

- **Incorrect strict style of interaction:** Anne shared her idea of how come there might be some kinds of teachers who are strict to their students but do not truly interact with them. She found that, “These teachers merely blame their students’ for their faults but don’t really listen to their students’ thoughts”. Anne assumed that these teachers’ families may not have taught them the valuable lesson of interacting with others, so they usually have problems interacting with their students or even co-workers as well. “They may be so hard-working and have such high expectation of themselves that they project and expect the same from their kids which is totally inappropriate.” Anne stated that. I agree with Anne, as a student’s cognition is not the same as the teachers’ ones.

“Interacting with a student’s heart is more important than teaching him/her.” ‘This kind

of teacher is relatively subjective in their judgement scales of learners.” “They do not want or accept the opinions of others as they consider those as judgments on themselves, so they reject them and choose not to listen at all.” “When that’s the way the teachers interact with peers, it’s usually the way they interact with kids or even with higher authority.” Anne concluded that, “A teacher needs to be more flexible to be strict and kind in a balanced way”.

• **Anne’s acceptance toward students:** Anne will inform a student whether he/she is slow or smart in English, but she still appreciates his/her individuality. For example, she had informed a learner who had to redo a level that, “You are actually good and you play basketball so well; I will never be able to do that. As long as you try harder next time, you’ll learn English better. Someday in the future, you may play basketball in another country, English will be useful.”

• **My view:** Anne recognizes almost every weak student’s problems and worries. Mostly, slow students seem to think that a teacher won’t like them because their learning is so bad. However, Anne said a lot of time that her favorite student isn’t the smartest one. She encouraged the sporty student and gave him the power to go on and appreciate his own special skill. She cleverly managed to link his English learning and this student’s specialty and passion together.

• **Anne’s family educational style:** Anne discussed with me about teachers who may not be able to balance being nice and strict to the students. Anne asks herself a question when dealing with students, “Am I going to be a serious father or a kind mother”. She recalled that

she had great relationship with her mom but she relied on her. Anne said, “My brother and sisters were all afraid of our father, but we loved our father in another way, different from our emotions for mom. We all considered that our father taught us much more.”

- **My view:** This style of teaching can build up kids’ self-esteem and confidence as they realize that they are capable of surviving in the world better because they have taken their father’s realistic advice and requirements.

- **Anne’s choice and balance:** If, teacher Anne views herself as a teacher who has to make a choice she would be a ‘strict father’ and teach her students more. However, being a “strict father” doesn’t mean that a teacher is being merely strict but also she/he will give love when necessary. This is done by some little actions or other ways, which could be as simple as a smile of agreement, subtle encouragement and so on. The key point for Anne to be a ‘strict father’ is that a teacher doesn’t show her kindness in front of a whole class so that they think they can get away with being rude or out of control.

- **Inappropriate learning request:** Besides being a ‘strict father’ for better control and teaching a class more, teacher Anne mentioned that, “I do not think not being able to learn English well is a really troubling problem and that it’s certainly not serious enough to deny the student’s personality”. Subsequently, when she tries to communicate with parents, she focuses on any required learning necessary rather than personal comments. She thinks that it’s an important way to prevent damaging the students’ and parents’ self-esteem.

Anne stated that “a lot of students are forced by their parents to learn English. They

aren't supposed to learn English at their particular ages for any survival reasons". "Students' learning outcomes may be reduced if they were forced to do something by their parents." "A teacher can't really inform the parents of how poorly their kids are progressing bluntly, as it would be inappropriate and may even discourage further learning." Anne will simply inform the parents that they can try to help the child at least pass each level and not waste their tuition fees.

• **Challenges for Anne – parenting style:** Anne shared some troublesome parents' thoughts. "There are some new parents out there who do not get the point or the concept of being responsible." "They may allow their child to be absent from class all the time and think that it's fine, as the teachers will make the lessons up for them." "Learning is a right and a duty that both students and parents should take responsibility for," Anne claimed. "To commit to attendance is important, as making up lessons isn't as efficient as learning in class with the others." "It seems that responsible parents are in the minority." "The parents seem to have lost the point that there are much more important things than making up a lesson or the tuition fees." "The parents are educating their kids to be irresponsible towards learning." Kids have lost chances to enhance their self-esteem by being able to master tasks responsibly due to parent irresponsibility.

Being a teacher, Anne tries hard to keep her spirits up and remain positive to provide a powerful influence on her students. She explained that it's not the kids that consume most of her spirit, passion or patience but the parents.

• **Anne's learning experience:** Luckily, Anne presents herself as a pretty confident person and interacts with students or parents in a relatively comfortable way. She shared some of her memories of her elementary school teachers' treatment toward her, saying that some of them built up her self-esteem well whilst others didn't.

• **An unfair teacher:** She mentioned her fifth and sixth grade teacher who was extremely unpopular with the students as he was not fair to everyone. He conducted a tutor class after school with six of Anne's classmates and he treated these six students better than everyone else. Even today some of Anne's classmates still refuse to invite these six, who went to the teacher's tutor class, to their class reunions.

Anne does not mind whether these six classmates join the reunions or not as she thinks that it wasn't their faults but the teacher's. However, her mates think that this unfair teacher tainted their wonderful elementary school life.

• **Full marks story:** Anne did pretty well in elementary school so her parents did not think she needed the extra tutoring, and others simply could not afford it. Once there was a pretty curious incident that confused Anne for quite some time afterwards.

Anne scored full marks pretty often but this time her teacher asked her to let one of the students who attended his tutor class win the first prize for the mid-term test. Anne didn't understand why there couldn't be two first prizes since they both scored full marks. Anne was so genuinely naive that she did not sense that the teacher was being biased and unfair.

It wasn't until the second term test that Anne and her other mates found out that these six

students were memorizing answers by numbers. She then realized that she after all was the real first-prize winner, as she did not have to go to a tutor to memorize the answers to score full marks. Even though the teacher gave her second prize, she knew that she deserved the first prize. Due to this experience, Anne thinks being fair is so important to be a teacher.

- **My view:** This case made me realize that Anne was a person with a relatively good standard of self-esteem even when she was only in her fifth and sixth grade. The fact that she didn't get hurt by this teacher showed her resilience. Anne found the unreasonable truth to maintain her self-esteem. Anne explained she was lucky to have other fair teachers who had already directed her positively and valued other things and were fair towards both slow and smart students.

- **Overly fair teacher:** She playfully added that mostly, in her childhood, teachers still liked smarter and cute students and would ignore weaker ones. Interestingly, her first and second grade teacher treated everybody equally but coolly. She thinks this teacher might have needed to add more emotion to interact with their students fully.

- **Kelp story:** Fortunately, in her third and fourth grade, she encountered a fair and nice teacher. Even though Anne was a top student in class she would still be reminded of any mistakes seriously in front of everyone.

This teacher was different from other home teachers. For example other teachers always ate lunch in the teachers' room; this teacher would accompany her students. She didn't bother the students or stop students' from talking. She would look at her students' lunch boxes

several times and found Anne's lunch seemed not to be nutritious enough.

She gave Anne kelp. Anne was initially scared of eating kelp, as she couldn't bear the smell. However, because it was given by a teacher, she didn't dare to reject it but tried to explain that she didn't dare to eat it. The teacher encouraged her saying, "don't worry, just eat it, it tastes better than it smells". So Anne ate it and it was surprisingly good. This teacher changed Anne's concept of certain types of food a lot by encouraging her to try new things first before making any judgments. Anne thanks this teacher for cultivating her positive thinking attitude toward different things very much. Thinking back Anne believes that's part of the important reason that she didn't get so upset by that unfair teacher.

• **My view:** Treating every student fairly is an important issue. Shr (2007) conducted research on fairness issues. Students will perform well if they are treated fairly and fairness is promoted. She summarized in her suggestions for teachers that:

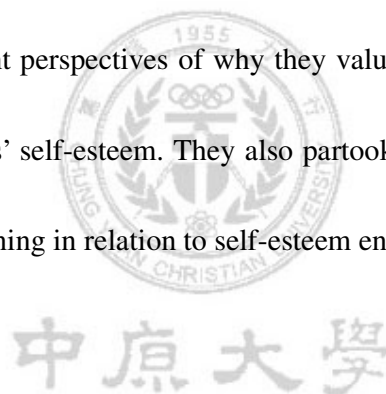
“First, the student knows about the rights of respecting everyone. Secondly, the student treats everyone equally. Thirdly, the student can tell the truth and be responsible for himself or herself. Fourthly, the student would like to take this responsibility and complete the work, depending on his/her wisdom and abilities. Fifthly, the student can be merciful to everyone, and is willing to share something with someone. More importantly, the "fair" concept needs to be internalized for a long time. (p.117)”

CHAPTER FIVE

DATA ANALYSIS – TWO

TRIANGULATIONS

In this section, the triangulation participants are Frances, the supervisor of the three angel participant teachers, Evita and Sharon, two colleagues of the three teachers, and the total outsider Teacher Maggie. Frances, Evita and Sharon commented the class observation experiences of and working experiences with the three angel participant teachers. They shared some similar and also different perspectives of why they value them as good model teachers in terms of enhancing learners' self-esteem. They also partook some of their own experience as philosophy of teaching/learning in relation to self-esteem enhancement and harming.



5.1 The Supervisor's Perspectives - Frances to the Three Teachers

The supervisor of our branch is called Frances. She has long standing friendships and business work experiences with all three teachers. She trusts them very much in many ways.

- **The redo requirement:** Frances has mentioned their appropriate solutions to the most troublesome situations that occur in our language institute in terms of dealing with learners' self-esteem. I mentioned earlier in the insider section that there is a redo requirement for slower or weaker students to re-learn the same level and materials of the system. Anne had shared her way to finally encourage a student who had to re-study a level.

Frances stated that, “A lot of teachers may mistake this requirement as a chance to negate the students they think incapable of learning in many ways”. Frances found that these three teachers on the other hand, regard this as a helpful additional education and inform parents that, “Needing to redo doesn’t mean that your child is stupid or incapable.” “Everyone is good and weak in different things and learn at different speeds that are just not comparable.” “A kid might need to do something two or three times to learn something in a particular subject but are very sufficient in other subjects.” Or “they merely haven’t met the standard of English yet, in the time provided”. “This could be due to a number of factors, timing, inspiration, motivation and so on.” These three teachers do not communicate with the parents about these issues negatively. They simply focus on the points of learning sufficiency enough to encourage both the learner and the parents.

Frances really appreciates the skills and positive thinking of these three teachers while they are dealing with learners and parents’ self-esteem. She thinks letting parents and learners know that they aren’t incapable is significant and that the teachers will elaborate on what is beneficial for the learning requirements.

- **My view:** Huang (2004) conducted research on the redo or returned probationary students’ learning outcomes. He found that, “Most of these students’ motivations are low”. “They were not satisfied with their own learning attitude the most. Their self-efficacy and expectation of success is quite low as well.” When dealing with students who have initially failed to learn sufficiently, teachers do have to be careful and provide hope to encourage their

future learning. They need to provide one more chances for slower students and engage their willingness to participate fully.

- **Good timing factors for English learning:** Frances states that a learner might need to grow to a particular age and mature enough so that she or he realizes the need of an additional language to motivate them to learn in her opinion. Pevin includes extra material to make it interesting for students for the same reasons as Frances. For example, there could be an English song or a star that interests a learner enough to want to learn that language. That's also her own experience as she wasn't interested in English when she was first taught it in junior high school at all. She thinks, "Learning a language is not only about grammar analysis but also an exploration about cultural thinking".

- **My view:** Kung (2008) had done research on the motivation and attitude towards culture and English learning. She proved that students receiving English movies and songs were more motivated to learn English than those who do not.

- **Motivation matters very much:** Frances mentioned that, "These three teachers are thoughtful and understanding when they find that students lack motivation to learn". "They don't over react or request too much from them to prevent from damaging their self-esteem any further". She mentioned a similar point as Anne did that, "Students are forced to learn in our schools unconsciously and with a clueless mind. "They do not realize why they have to learn English."

She observed cases, for instance, "An older student, who might be addicted to computer

games which require English to play them, may be more actively motivated to learn. He/she does not care about being laughed at or damaging his/her self-esteem as he/she is motivated completely and try hard to ask teachers questions”. Frances thinks, “This is a much better way than a learner who lacks of interest and will always be at a disadvantage as he/she does not want to learn”. Frances considers, “The motivations cannot be expected from all learners so a teacher should not damage learners while they are not performing well as if they are stupid”. When learners are meditative, “A teacher is not merely teaching English but providing them with experiences of a different world”.

• **My view:** I do appreciate this concept, as a teacher won't be with a learner forever, the learner needs to be able to motivate themselves. In this way, teachers and students are not simply playing set roles, trying to damage each other's self-esteems, but are co-workers in building abilities, as it's a two-way process.

• **Frances' own self-esteem damage learning experience:** Frances also shared a negative experience of her own when her self-esteem was damaged by a teacher and how she built it back up when she realized the importance of the subject and that she was capable of doing it.

There was a home teacher in her elementary school that taught all her subjects including math. This teacher punished students physically when they did not understand her or did poorly in the tests. Frances said that her self-esteem was seriously hurt as, “She was made to feel like she was stupid and so she was punished”. Frances really disagrees with this as, “she

doesn't think physical punishment is all wrong if a student did make a mistake". "However, being unable to understand is not a mistake that deserves a punishment."

This teacher even pinched the chins of students when they did poorly in their tests and asked them to crouch in front of the black board to listen to the lesson. Frances said, "That was so uncomfortable to crouch there. How could I learn any better while I was in a worse circumstance? This did insult me very much. This teacher merely yelled at students when they didn't understand and did poorly in tests but this teacher did not explain to them why they got it wrong!"

This terrible experience made her hate math so much that she only got four points in her math on the Joint College Entrance Exam.

• **My view:** For me, I think a learner's being fail to understand or learn is relatively speaking the 'mistake' of the teacher who should try to explain things differently as students' have different needs or learning styles. Some students may not be able to understand a pure pattern without a real world example. Liu (2005) conducted research on math teaching and learning. She found that the connection between abstract symbols, concepts and concrete material examples, are rarely seen in the math classroom. She found that some teachers still failed to prevent students from making mistakes about math concepts till mid-term tests.

• **A turning point - a TV program:** After she grew up, Frances was watching TV about a program explaining the needs of math in our daily life. She suddenly understood the meaning of "rooting" ($\sqrt{4}=2$), and she saw how and why we can know the length of a room

when we first know its area. Her self-esteem was lifted because she realized that being unable to understand wasn't due to her incapability.

Frances recalled that her teacher was an old guy who might have already lost patience and passion for teaching and always interacted with his class in a bad way. She was jealous of the other class' home teacher who was young and had just graduated from school and still possessed great enthusiasm, patience and passion.

- **The value of the three experienced but “new” teachers:** That is one of the reasons that she appreciates Anne, Charlotte and Pevin so much because they still have passion and patience for teaching and working when they are no longer new teachers.

Frances takes Anne as a good example, “Anne does not take anything for granted. Anne will communicate with me and discuss with me problems that a particular student is encountering”. Frances thinks a teacher who lacks passion won't even consider a slow student's learning needs.

Frances said, “Charlotte will try so hard to rebuild a class's behavior and habits to improve their learning if she gets them from an inexperienced teacher, whereas a teacher who lacks patience would only complain about the mistakes and faults of the ex-teacher, rather than trying to solve them to help the learners.”

“Pevin will always carry a huge bag of gifts and snacks for her students on game's day even though she rides a motorcycle to work!” Frances knows that buying gifts or snacks for learners reveals a teacher's willingness to rewarding the students.

“These three experienced teachers do not think they are so senior that they won’t encounter any new challenges in considerations of the individuals’ needs.” Frances also observed that these teachers know their students enough to set different goal for their different students”. Frances stated that, “They often spend extra time on slower students. Slower students are those who require much more attention from their teachers to learn, but smart students require relatively less support from their teachers.”

- **Principles to follow:** Frances concluded with some points that she feels a teacher requires enhancing students’ self-esteem or at least not to harm them.

- **Slow students:** Firstly, she thinks, “Teachers should not take a slow student’s situation personally as a teacher has to build a relatively positive learning environment for everyone. They have to understand that this is a very common problem and that’s the area the teacher needs to work on.”

- **Relationship:** Secondly, “a teacher needs to spend some quality time to build up relationships with students. If the relationship between a student and a teacher is harmonious, a student will probably try to learn well for this teacher as he/she has already become friends.”

- **Parents’ roles:** Thirdly, Frances thinks that, communicating with parents is also important. “Some parents might not sense their essential and important roles in their children’s learning.” “They might simply send their kids to the teachers and think the teacher needs to wholly take care of their kids’ learning needs.” “Teachers can try to inform them about their necessary roles and share with them their children’s improvement and needs.” In

this way, teachers, students and parents are all clear about their responsibilities and their correct roles.

“Every student should be able to experience the sense of achievement at mastering a subject such as learning English.” “This process might not be easy and take a long time but, once they sense their capabilities, their self-esteem and subsequently their parents’ self-esteem will be enhanced.”

• **Value a student & inform his/her parents:** Fourthly, Frances states, “Valuing a student’s strengths and advantages is a key point.” “Even if a student’s learning outcome is not quite good enough, a teacher still needs to try to find his/her value and inform the student and his/her parents of it.” “Moreover, the teacher can make use of this student’s strengths to extend his/her own expectations of his/her learning and so improve him/her”.

That’s what Anne achieved with her sporty student. “If a teacher merely says you should do this and do that without taking into consideration of his/her views or values, a student will definitely not do this or that,” Frances emphasized.

The story of the ‘Sun and the Wind’ might be a platitude for every one but means so much to Frances. (In the Sun and Wind story, the Wind bet that he would make the walking man take off his jacket and so did the Sun. The Wind blew so hard but the walking man hold his jacket even tighter. The Sun warmed the walking man and he felt hot to take off his jacket. The “warm” Sun won.)

“Parents’ self-esteem is enhanced in a big way when they hear their children being

praised as the teacher warmed them so much.” Frances will share real examples with the parents about who had done what to help their kids and how much they improved rather than just merely request the parents what they should do. Frances appreciates the parents for their hard work when trying to improve their children’s learning. Praising a parent’s child, and sharing visions of success are the best ways to enhance the parents’ and the student’s self-esteem and to enhance his/her willingness to learn.

- **Empathy:** Fifthly, “a teacher must process empathy”. Frances said that, “Once a teacher can imagine what kind of teacher they’d expect if they had a child of their own, then they are standing on a similar foot hold with the parents.”

- **Power of apology:** Sixthly, “a teacher must be willing to apologize to the kids. If a teacher hurts a student’s self-esteem, apologizing should be sufficient”. This can encourage a student a lot. A teacher can honestly inform a student of the expectations of him/her as a teacher considers a student capable of achieving the goal. “Being respected, trusted and apologized to by a teacher, who is powerful in status, makes a student realize his/her worth and should enhance his/her esteem and willingness to try harder and learn.”

- **Retrospect:** Finally, “a teacher should be retrospective and reflective often to see if she/he could have done something differently or better to facilitate a student to learn”.

“These three angel teachers all possess these important features and have flexible personalities to achieve these points. They are good role models and do enhance student’s learning, they interact well with their students and build good self-esteem,” Frances

concluded.

5.2 The Colleague's Perspectives - Evita to Anne

Teacher Evita is another experienced teacher who had been both a full-time and a part-time teacher in this language school. I observed students of hers being around her often before and after classes. She has had experiences of substituting teacher Anne's class and has observed her teaching many times.

- **Comprehensive instruction:** In Evita's memory, Anne impressed her most in the way that Anne speaks to the students slowly enough to enhance their comprehension while learning English in English. This is a language school that does not allow either teachers or students to speak Chinese, but only English during learning.

Anne emphasized that, "Having students understand at a higher percentage as possible is significant to enhance learners' self-esteem because if they are not able to get the point of what the teachers are saying, they will lose the willingness and faith to learn quickly".

- **My view:** Yu (2008) has done research on language school students' English learning processes. She found that standard teaching processes and a no-Chinese speaking request helped students use the language. This can be a really good method in terms of practicing speaking ability and establishing classroom discipline. Some of the issues about cultural bias are not problems with these teachers and in my experience as long as the teacher and the material have a good attitude toward our native culture then learning the foreign one does not

overshadow it.

Liu (2005) has research on English learning conditions in early childhood education. She found that, “the partiality in culture valuing was not reflected in a bilingual class”.

• **Challenge from an Asperger’s Syndrome student:** Another observation of Anne that impressed Evita a great deal was when Anne had a hyperactive student who had Asperger’s Syndrome to deal with in her class.

Elementary students with Asperger’s Syndrome may display attention deficit, hyperactivity disorder and attacking behavior (Chen, 2007).

This student’s name was Mickey and he came to our branch while Evita was still a full-time teacher. Mickey’s mom had informed the secretary that her son was diagnosed as a hyperactive child to check if our branch would accept him.

Carelessly, the secretary did not remember to inform teacher Anne of the facts. The first class Anne and Mickey had together was dramatically dangerous. Mickey got angry when Anne reminded him to concentrate and write down notes as she did to all the other students. In his anger he threw his shoe at teacher Anne’s head. Luckily, the shoe hit the board rather than Anne’s head. The whole class was shocked. Anne was not only scared but also angry. Evita was observing Anne’s lesson in the classroom and saw the whole incident.

Anne quickly calmed down and thought about a solution while Mickey ran out of the classroom. Anne asked a smart and mature student to follow Mickey carefully and to inform the secretary that this student had ran out of the classroom.

Evita then took this chance to inform Anne about this student's problem. Anne soon realized the situation and took the opportunity to educate the whole class about it and stressed to them that she might have to be more generous to this student. She also stressed that it didn't mean the other students were allowed to be naughty or out of control, as, "You are supposed to be thankful that you are healthy". Evita observed how Anne dealt with this possibly unfair issue and what might happen afterwards but students in this class rarely kicked up a fuss while Mickey was making noise.

Mickey has been learning well in this language school for more than three years now and trusts Anne very much. Anne does not dislike him for his illness but accepts him like everyone else and has educated everyone to accept him. Evita found that this was a good chance for these young students to learn how to interact with different people and include them rather than ask them to change class.

Evita not only had a chance to observe this important event but also had a chance to substitute Mickey's class. Evita was reminded by Anne not to take his words to heart too much and don't be too upset by him or to upset him either. She had chance to feel the atmosphere of Anne's class and interact with them and Mickey about any unfair issues.

Evita mentioned that, "It's very possible for a teacher to be unfair in class unconsciously". "This will probably cause learners to be really unhappy and not want to learn anymore afterwards." They will give up trying harder to learn as they may think "whatever I do the teacher won't appreciate it as the teacher does with the others so why do I have to work

hard anyway”. “There will always be students that please a teacher more than others but a teacher shouldn’t show it in front of everyone.” “This should be done carefully and appropriately, maybe privately to enhance everyone’s self-esteem sometimes.”

- **My view:** I have had many experiences of unfair treatment by my own teachers that harmed my self-esteem. I sensed that teachers were treating me differently from other classmates, who I considered better than me in some way, and that these powerful adults who I felt inferior to, were judging me. Successfully dealing with fairness issues is an important mission for any teacher to achieve.

- **Argument solutions:** Evita also observed some important skills that Anne possessed when she dealt with students’ arguments. It’s pretty normal for students to play together in the break time and sometimes they carelessly hurt each other either with words or physically. Once it happens, students usually come to the teacher and ask for a judgment. Evita found some teachers do not try to solve the problems but yell at both parties and ask them to go back to classroom without a break. This could cause students to be resentful and complain to their parents when they get home. “Anne will listen to both sides of the story and give the students chance to say ‘sorry’ and ‘it’s okay’ to each other to maintain the relationship”, Evita observed.

- **Assignment problems:** Another situation is when students come to admit that they have failed to finish their assignment. Some teachers might merely punish the students without understanding the reasons. Evita thinks that, “There are some students who do have a

bad habit of delaying assignments; however, there are still cases with reasonable cause for delaying these assignments.” Evita observed, “Anne gives chances to the honest students, who admit their mistakes, and try to explain their reasons.” “Anne always speaks to the students calmly rather than yells or shouts at them, as Anne is an emotionally stable person.”

• **Facial expressions, tone, and intonation:** Evita and I both think this is a key point in at least not humiliating and damaging a student’s self-esteem. This is because it’s not only words themselves that can damage someone’s confidence but also how these words are delivered e.g. facial expressions, tone, intonation etc. Evita heard about a student complaining about her new teacher who praised her classmates much more wholeheartedly than to her. She realized that not only giving praise can affect someone but also giving it genuinely and from the heart can be easily sensed and perceived by students.

• **Equal opportunities in class:** Evita learnt from Anne that giving an equal chance for all the students to speak out is important as well as equally encouraging every student. Evita would rather let the smarter students give hints to the slower ones to provide a chance for the slower students to speak out rather than make them being silent and hopelessly waiting. Evita observed that “Some students might know the answers but are not sure enough about themselves to speak out”.

• **Evita’s speaking learning thoughts and self-esteem:** She also shared her own experiences about learning how to speak English that, “Being an introvert especially as a student I was so uncomfortably speaking out and not sure whether I was using the right words

or pronunciation.” Evita thinks, “English teachers really should try harder to encourage introversive students to speak out using positive encouragement.” “I would have learnt to speak better if I’d had a teacher who would have encouraged me more or directed me to practice speaking.” “I was more confident about my writing and found my speaking actually improved much slower.” “The emphasis of the English education system in the past was on writing merely to pass tests and this reflected the teaching methods.” “Students learning English nowadays might be required to work harder but they are also luckier as they get more chances to practice speaking.”

• **My view:** I do agree with Evita as I was an introversive student in terms of learning English speaking. I had real chance to speak English when I was in college. However, since Evita and I had no chance to experience the chance to speak more in younger age, we may not know how hard it would be and what kind of teacher might fit our needs.

• **Students’ weaknesses informing:** Another issue is about how to appropriately inform students of their weaknesses. Evita shared that “some students might not be able to write neatly and some teachers might just tell them that their written work is ugly. This bluntness could upset a student and may improve his/her writing but also could damage his/her self-esteem so much. Certain negative adjectives are unacceptable and need to be avoided when talking to students”, Evita emphasized, and that’s also what she observed Anne did well.

5.3 The Colleague's Perspectives - Evita to Pevin

- **Different thoughts from Pevin toward speaking enhancing:** Teacher Evita has somewhat different ideas from Pevin on how to encourage students to speak out in class when they teach a high level class. Evita observed Pevin's class and found some students were relatively quiet in class and did not speak at all. Evita went to discuss the situation with Pevin. Pevin explained her thoughts saying that, "she did not want to push learners to speak, as she does in her lower level students because, at higher levels, they are mature enough to know that they are supposed to speak out". In this language school, speaking in class is a requirement for students. Teachers usually have a competition system to reward students' behavior in class including participation in speaking.

- **My view:** Competition with group collaboration is an effective way to discipline students and motivate learning in the classroom in these teachers' experiences. However, teachers do have to consider the effect of damaging the self-esteem of less competitive students with this type of system (Huang, 2006).

- **Evita's different strategies and outcomes:** Pevin had two students transferred to Evita's class due to class closure. The two students were so quiet at the very beginning but to teacher Evita they chatted with her a lot, loudly and happily after class rather than in class. After a few days, Evita said to them, "Since you like to talk so much after class, you should talk in English somewhat more IN class". Evita won't push a new student in her class to speak but she will observe the student for some time and then deal with his/her problems.

Her method of doing this is to divide the class into a lot of smaller groups with fewer people in them to push every one to speak out. They can earn points for their teams and don't have the luxury to rely on the talkative ones, as they can't 'hide' in a smaller team. So, it's easier to see if an individual hasn't contributed to their team's points.

The two students in question were actually smart and excellent at writing and their situation did improve. Evita observed that these students did become more confident in speaking due to her methods.

• **Calm & stable personality:** As for students' interaction with Pevin, Evita agrees with Pevin's solution which is similar to Anne's method. Pevin is also a person with a calm and stable emotional state and has a pleasant personality when dealing with students' problems. She once observed Pevin informing a teacher that her students were crying and arguing. When the teacher simply yelled at them without knowing the reasons for all this, Pevin reminded the teacher to understand the situation in the first instance before reacting.

• **Sandwich strategy:** Evita has also observed how Anne and Pevin communicate with the parents during telephone tests and/or in person.

They both utilize a "sandwich" method, which is basically - good points followed by, needing improving points followed by, good points again. The term 'sandwich' is used as an analogy which is easily understood to give a metaphor. They encourage the parents with what their children did pretty well. Secondly they inform the parents about their children's weaknesses and areas that need improvement. And finally, which is important, encourage the

parents' about their children's strengths again or mention other advantages this student has.

To sum up, this is one of the best skills she learnt from Pevin and Anne for the parents and children to leave on a positive note.

5.4 The Colleague's Perspectives - Sharon to Anne

Sharon is another experienced and patient teacher with super organizational skills who could handle and discipline the class. She had also been a full-time and part-time teacher as well as Evita in this language school.

- **Longer substitution of Anne's class:** Similar to Evita who has had experience in substituting teacher Anne's class containing Mickey, Sharon taught that class for several levels while Anne went aboard for a while. Sharon was the only teacher who was thought to be capable of taking that class by the supervisors.

She found that Mickey liked teacher Anne a great deal while she was substituting Mickey's class for Anne. More surprisingly to Sharon was the fact that the other students in this class did not seem to mind his misbehavior so much (such things like throwing things or saying bad words). They seemed able and willing to include this special classmate even though a hyperactive student can usually be trouble when learning or have social problems. This kind of students can annoy others and cause complaints to the teachers very often. Evita and Sharon both observed Anne's successful interaction with this particular student and the class as a whole.

Sharon found that Anne appreciates Mickey in the way he speaks and tries to enhance his learning and self-esteem so she tries to make him feel comfortable enough to learn and get alone with his other classmates.

Mickey asked Sharon a lot about why Anne was absent and when she would be coming back. Sharon also saw that Mickey liked English very much and always tried hard to memorize any conversations to perform his best when speaking. His self-esteem and confidence in learning English and getting alone with others was safely protected and enhanced in this class, Sharon observed.

• **Similar comments and observation on Anne among teachers:** Sharon has observed that Anne is a relatively positive teacher and Frances and Evita have recognized this aspect of her personality especially with her attitude to her students. For example, Anne does not blame students for their failings to finish assignments but usually communicates and encourages the student first; then she will communicate with the parents to inform them of the necessity of fulfilling these requests at home.

• **The balance of punishment:** Anne had shared previously with Sharon tips on how she deals with this hyperactive student. Anne had informed Mickey that if he hit someone or hurt someone, then she would ask him to get out of class for a moment to calm down before returning. This was a deadline for Mickey to obey Anne and she also negotiated a consensus with Mickey's parents' on how she would deal with their son. Mickey's mom trusts Anne very much as well.

Sharon compared a small example of a teacher's generosity when interacting with students with Mickey's case. Sharon thinks that asking a student to get out off a classroom isn't a good solution when the problem is not as serious as Mickey's case. For instance, students forget one or more of their textbooks sometimes and she has seen a teacher ask a student to get out when this student forgot her textbook. Sharon argued that, maybe, they had already set up the rules of what the punishment would be if anyone forgets his/her textbooks; however Sharon still doesn't agree with this solution.

• **My view:** I understand Sharon's viewpoint as I think the feeling of being asked to get out by the teacher is a bit extreme and will separate one from others as if one does not belong to this group because one is being bad. This can harm a student's self-esteem. If a student, being in a class, influences others' ability to learn, then it's more acceptable to have him/her leave, which decreases the harm of self-esteem.

• **Effective discipline system:** Anne has another good skill that Sharon appreciates a lot. Sharon observed that Anne's students follow her directions to do writing, speaking, reading and listening effectively. Teachers working in this language school know that being able to direct students efficiently to follow the activities saves time and is an artful and useful skill. Some teachers might need to yell at their students to get them, unwillingly, to do what teachers say.

Sharon observed that Anne's students were so organized while doing any assigned activities. The point is that Anne does not have to be angry with them to achieve this,

meaning the lesson is learnt in a positive and efficient manner. Sharon contributed Anne's success to two main reasons, i.e., her discipline system was well organized and her attitude toward students was clear and precise.

Compared to unsuccessful teachers in relation to achieving this goal, Sharon thinks Anne has stable and consistent principles about how to conduct punishment or rewards to establish and reinforce her clear instructions to her students. They understand that she is nice when students are following her rules and steps and she won't be nice if they are not. Moreover, Sharon thinks informing the students of class rules in advance is necessary.

Sharon thinks students will perform better if they realize the rules in advance for them to follow and achieve instead of testing what is okay or what isn't, which consumes time meaninglessly. An inexperienced teacher might not be able to build up this step-by-step discipline system, which allows fairness issues come up and maybe damage self-esteem. This may cause confusion for all and the teacher may deal with problems by displaying unfair feelings of students whether they are hard working, lazy or challenging, disproportionately.

- **My view:** I deeply agree with that, if a teacher does so, it's unlikely to hurt a student's self esteem as he/she knows what he/she is being punished for and everyone is getting the same treatment and message. Because, he/she is punished as he/she did something bad instead of his/her being bad.

5.5 The Colleague's Perspectives - Sharon to Pevin

- **Silent students:** Sharon mentioned speaking issues as well as Evita did about Pevin's class. She had about three students from Pevin's class who she found to be almost silent in speaking practice. The way she deals with this type of problem isn't the same as Evita's grouping method.

- **Different strategies:** Sharon thinks different students need different styles of teachers to enhance their learning. "Introvert students might be more scared of speaking while she or he is facing a teacher's pushy tone and face. The three students were speaking like birds at the very beginning of transferring to her class. Sharon encouraged the silent students to speak a little louder and then praised them straight away. She gives everyone different levels of tasks to achieve. "If a student is so shy that he/she speaks so quietly, then I will consider he/she has improved if he/she tries to be a little louder." Sharon thinks a teacher does not need to request an introvert student to speak as loudly as others but at least speak out. This idea matched Frances' setting different goals for different students.

Pevin explained to Sharon the same way she did to Evita that she does not want to push her students to make them feel even more uncomfortable. Sharon thinks there can be a balance achieved between Pevin's talkative and silent students.

- **My view: the myths of introversion qualities:** The terms of extrovert and introvert are confused sometimes and may have been misunderstood in Evita and Sharon's concepts. Brown (2000) compiled the definitions and features of these personality types. Some types of

extroverts can actually be pretty shy but will still perform tasks, as they need the affirmation from others. I therefore could assume that those students who transferred to Evita's class might be relatively extrovert, as they would go to Evita in the break time to earn some of affirmations from Evita.

5.6 The Outsider's Perspectives- Maggie to the Three Teachers

- **Charlotte's case - Robin:** Maggie is another teacher who really appreciates Robin's mom, who displayed great cooperation. She informed Charlotte of her son's speech impediment right at the start. Maggie considers the cooperation of parents as the most stable focus for teachers to facilitate a student's learning.

Maggie thinks Charlotte was so thorough to find Robin's strengths including speaking in front of a machine. "For a student with a speech impediment to improve speaking in a foreign language is a huge task. "Charlotte is obviously good at seeing and identifying a student's advantages," Maggie said. The improvement in Robin's speech performances has really touched Maggie.

Maggie also appreciated Charlotte praising Robin in front of the whole class. Maggie thinks this probably enhanced Robin's self-esteem very much and sees his future potential in speaking. Maggie thinks, "A teacher can direct a student to achieve what a student might not think he/she is capable of doing it.

Charlotte's praise to Robin was both appropriate in words and in timing". She

emphasized the importance of timing. “Praise can be empty and meaningless if a student doesn’t do something right. A teacher needs to grasp the chance when a student performs well in anyway to praise him/her. Praise can be so unuseful if a teacher misses the timing.”

- **Parents love to compare:** Parenting is also a key issue in the enhancement of self-esteem for Maggie, who is both a teacher and a parent. Maggie thinks, “Parents need to learn to compare their child’s previous performance and present improvement rather than compare their child to others. Comparing with others sometimes merely makes a child sense his or her incapability,” Maggie explained. Maggie is a teacher who hates to compete.

- **Pevin’s case – Vito:** As for Pevin’s student, Vito, teacher Maggie thinks that, “Teachers need to rid themselves of their ‘own expectations and preset ideas’ to see any change or improvements in the students they are teaching.” In her experience, there are a lot of students who do not grow up the way teachers expect them to. “Some students might need to be informed only once to learn, but others might need to be informed a hundred times or a thousand times before any improvement or change is seen.

However, an educator has no right to give up on a student as it is the educator’s job and role to keep trying.” This could be difficult for a teacher and even challenge his or her own self-esteem very much. Maggie feels happy that Pevin was informed that Vito was doing better in the next teacher’s class. Maggie said this is so called ‘growing’. The “growing” idea matches Frances’ one.

- **Wait and see:** “What a teacher does must leave some influence on a student, even if it

does not show while this teacher is with him/her.” Vito may not get the point of what teacher Pevin said to him right then but Maggie trusts that he will understand what is right or wrong when he reflects on her words one day in the future and enable him to behave the way others do with better people skills.

• **Pevin’s case – Jimmy:** As for the dramatic drama actor Jimmy, Maggie considers Pevin was so nice to spend extra time to help him and thoughtful in her suggestion to him to attend the grammar class to improve his understanding of patterns better. Maggie thinks this kind of student is easy to improve as he is willing to learn and will try harder to improve himself. However, some careless teachers might have ignored this kind of lack of confidence students because they lacked the passion or confidence to support them.

• **Proper praise at the right time:** Maggie is so happy that her own ideas about proper praise at the right time can enhance a student’s confidence and self-esteem so sufficiently. She understands the improvement in Jimmy’s learning and self- esteem in class after his successful conversation performance. She said, “A teacher’s praise and peers’ acknowledgements will make a learner feel much more comfortable in learning in the classroom.”

• **My view:** I deeply agree with Maggie’s words as I found my drive to learn in a group after the teacher admired my hard work or praised my good performance. Maggie thinks that these are valuable chances for learners to make huge breakthroughs.

Maggie believes that Jimmy will be even more capable of achieving challenging tasks in

learning English in the future, as long as Pevin keeps praising him right after any of his good performances. “Jimmy will figure out his road in life and build proper self-esteem in this kind of positive environment. It’s an honor for a teacher to accompany a student on this road and provide him with positive, happy memories when he is growing,” Maggie faithfully claimed.

• **Anne’s case – Jack, competition damage:** As for Jack, teacher Anne’s weak student, Maggie thinks it’s similar to her own concepts but disagrees with competition. Maggie emphasized, “Students are to be encouraged and created to come to schools. They deserve learning chances whether their learning outcomes are outstanding or weak.” Maggie appreciates that Anne praised his improvements and praised him while Anne was practicing with him individually. Maggie also appreciates Anne rewarded the students so generously.

Maggie concluded that praise to the student, reflects on their parents, and praising the student in front of their peers enhance a learner’s self esteem significantly and probably the most.

5.7 The Researcher’s Perspectives- Class Observations

I observed Charlotte, Pevin and Anne for six to nine hours each, two to three hours for each class. I observed each of their beginners, intermediate and higher level classes. I came to their classes early to have chance to observe how they interacted with their students before class and left later to observe their after class periods as well.

What I saw pretty much matched their supervisor’s and colleagues’ perspectives. They

are all people with stable emotions and positive attitudes. I would like to share some of the three teachers' specialties.

- **The absence of perspectives to Charlotte of Evita & Sharon:** Charlotte is a super senior teacher and Sharon and Evita have both observed her class about seven or eight years ago so their memories are vague and not that clear.

- **Charlotte's class:** But, they do remember Charlotte liked to say, "I love you" to the students and that they said, "I love you" back to Charlotte. That's what I still saw Charlotte do in class now. Carlson (1988) suggested that, "A parents' understanding of how to speak to their children is a requirement in building self-esteem in families". "If no one said, 'I love you,' we would doubt our lovable-ness!"

Charlotte shared with me that it's not only a way to teach a class happily and interestingly but also to have the students sense they are cared for by the teacher. Almost everyone in her class looked like they were't shy about saying it back, in fact longing to say it. That's a pretty successful classroom atmosphere to establish learning in.

- **Pevin's class:** In Pevin's class, I observed that she successfully led the class in doing numerous activities without rewarding them in any form. Pevin has built an active and responsible learning habit. Every student is capable of the new material which has just been taught and the students have the confidence to answer any of Pevin's questions before going home. Pevin shared with me that the reward and competition system is useful at the very beginning but the sense of achievement gained will be useful in the long run.

• **Anne's class:** Anne told a student off for copying homework from classmates so seriously that the student cried. However, after no more than five minutes, Anne praised the student with appropriate eye contact when he tried hard to follow the writing activities. I could see the student take a deep breath when he realised that he had earned Anne's trust back. Anne shared with me that breaking a student's self-esteem first, when he or she did things wrong, and then rebuilding it, when he or she tries to improve, is also necessary to enhance a learner's self-esteem more stably.

Having chances to observe these super passionate, patient and professional teachers' teaching again was a great honor.



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CHAPTER SIX

DISCUSSIONS

In this chapter, I reflected the data back to the literature section and provide the major findings of this research. Section 6.1 to 6.4 follows exactly the same order in the literature review. Each contains how some of the collected data information, perspectives and cases match or contradict with the definitions of the literature or findings of previous related studies in Taiwan or aboard. I specially isolated this reflection discussion sections from the data analysis and triangulation sections because I would like to keep the previous two chapters respectively so as to keep it as “narrative” as possible. In section 6.5, there will be my brief answers to my research questions and some discussions opposite to the ideas and opinions of the three angel teachers’ strategies and thoughts.

6.1 Definitions

I felt so touched that these teachers allowed me to interview them and graced me with such honesty and that their ideas and actions matched the literature I have researched so much. In the mathematical definition of William James (1890/1983), I better understand the self-esteem of the students in the above stories.

I assume Robin’s self-esteem in learning English might not be low anymore as he kind of understood his weaknesses so that he seemed not to over stretch himself and project his

potential too high, which showed great self-awareness. This increased his self-esteem of William James' (1890/1983) ratio to be closer to "1". Then he showed resilience and tried really hard to perform better and gained unexpected success.

Vito's social self-esteem was obviously low as he was trying pretty hard to make friends with others actively, though he didn't realise that he was going about it the wrong way, and it might change somewhat by teacher Pevin's intervention as Pevin was informed by the next teacher that his' emotional problems seemed to get better. Adler (1927) and Horney (1937) mentioned that there can be a gap between the 'ideal self and real self', which is reflected in Vito's case.

Jack displayed pretty unstable self-esteem. Jack's 'global self-esteem' or 'trait self-esteem' which can refer to his speaking Chinese and getting along with his peers appeared quite high and proper but his 'situational self-esteem' or 'state self-esteem,' which can refer to speaking English with teacher Anne was relatively low and variable. (Harter, 1999 & Greenier, Kernis & Waschull, 1995)

Jimmy's self-esteem in learning English was enhanced a lot after he sensed, "the mastery of a developmental task" (White 1959) with his vivid drama conversation performance success. In White (1959)'s definition, Jimmy might, "take the experience of efficacy as his taproot for his self-esteem" in his four grade childhood period.

'Ideal self' mentioned by Adler (1927) and Horney (1937), which can refer to parents' incorrect expectations toward their kids, is disputed by all the teachers. Teachers seem to have

similar ideas of comparing a student with himself/herself instead of comparing him/her with others by setting different goals for different students.

White's (1959) "motivational concept" was displayed in Charlotte's own example when her Chinese teacher promoted and enhanced her self-esteem with regards to her writing ability certainly enough to motivate her to continue writing.

Anne and Pevin's classes containing Jimmy and Jack respectively correspond to the definition of self-esteem as worthiness. Their classes are relatively outstanding anyway. Rosenberg (1965) defined that one is judged to be, 'good enough' by his or her 'scale items'. Therefore, being absolutely good enough or comparatively good enough in a particular group can harm one's self-esteem 'blindly' as seen in Anne and Pevin's excellent classes. Luckily, Anne and Pevin supported Jimmy and Jack to provide them their value of worthy of learning.

Baumeister, Smart, and Boden (1996) defined self-esteem as a "sense of superiority", which was proved in Jimmy's and Robin's cases. Their self-esteem was highly enhanced when teacher Charlotte played his tape in front of the whole class and Jimmy's conversation role play was praised. All teachers agreed the importance of praising a student in front of a class, which matched the definition in affording a learner the sense of superiority.

Nathaniel Branden's (1969) definition is strongly reflected by Maggie's idea when she mentioned that any learners are to be created rather than criticized. "One is competent to live and worthy of living" can be transformed to "one is competent to learn and worthy of learning."

6.2 Models and Theories

Robin and the hyperactive Mickey were accepted by Charlotte and Anne and their classmates for both their advantages and shortcomings like Frey and Carlock's (1989) "Eclectic Variations on a Humanistic Theme" which focused on the co-existence of the value of an individual's weakness and strength.

Pope, McHale & Craighead's (1988) "Increasing Self-Esteem Behaviorally" emphasized the domains of not only the academic but also social parameters as teacher Pevin did to Vito and Anne did to Jack, the sporty redo student.



6.3 Self-Esteem in SLA

All the teachers shared their ideas about learning to speak English and that it is most significantly related to self-esteem, which corresponds to Heyde's study (1979). The results showed that the three levels of self-esteem are correlated positively especially in oral performance. Charlotte mentioned, "Speaking requires higher self-esteem even to try" and Evita and Sharon emphasized the importance of teachers to "take care of quiet students' self-esteem when encouraging speaking."

Andrés (1999) is sure that, "successful teachers give attention to both linguistic goals and personality". Anne and Frances shared similar ideas about caring for a student more than his/her learning outcome. They both think that being unable to learn English well shouldn't

make a teacher deny a learner's personality as he/she is sometimes forced to learn.

6.4 Self-Esteem Enhancement

Carlson (1988) suggested a lot of sentences for parents to say to their children. The three teachers utilized a lot of them. Maggie and Charlotte liked to say "I love you" to their students. Robin and Mickey's moms acted to show their sons that they were, "glad you were born into our family". They accepted their weaknesses and informed the teachers to do the same.

As for, 'I can see you have done a good job,' as Charlotte said, "If no adult reminds a child, he or she will forget, or never even know." Anne proclaimed to Jack that he did his test so well. Frances appreciates the three teachers noticing each student's value. Pevin not only valued Vito, but also did not deny or ignore his negative thoughts as "it's okay to feel".

Interestingly, some of the conditions in the cases shared by the teachers match the previous self-esteem related studies mentioned in the literature section. For instance, the teachers shared a lot of good parenting skills and were good roles models when dealing with problems. In Christopher's (2006) self-esteem research findings categories of parental factors, the teachers mentioned similar ideas such as "parental support (involvement)", "warmth (acceptance)", "expectations" and "consistency".

Jack, Robin and Mickey's moms shared these features as parents who support their children and get involved in their learning. Vito's classmates showed an indifferent attitude towards him whereas Mickey's classmates showed warm acceptance. Anne shared her sense

of hopelessness with inconsistent parenting styles towards learning responsibilities and inappropriately high expectations of their children and their teachers.

Clark and Barber (1994), Coopersmith (1967) and Rosenberg (1965) had similar findings in their studies about indifferent and absent parents tending to have children with lower levels of self-esteem. This may prove why Vito's social self-esteem seemed so low as his father and mother were usually absent in his daily life.

Christopher's (2006) self-esteem enhancement techniques sections recognize, "providing consistent, positive (affirming) feedback" and enhancing self-esteem by "assertiveness training (empowerment)", and "increasing problem solving skills". Evita and Frances mentioned how powerful a teacher apologizing to a student can be, as this can reaffirm a student's self-esteem so much. Pevin shared how much she improved and her self-esteem enhanced by her college professor's training in utilizing independent thinking skills. Finally a positive attitude was deemed the most important aspect among teachers. Evita and Maggie emphasized that positive feedback included not only words but also facial expressions and intonations to be deemed as genuine. To sum up, my research data results match the literatures to a certain extent.

6.5 Answers to the Research Questions and Discussions

1. **How do the successful language school teachers enhanced elementary learners' self esteem to facilitate English learning by means of methods, strategies and so on?**

The three angel teachers all agreed the value of praise to enhance students' self-esteem. They emphasized the control of praise timing, intonation and the conditions where teachers praise students in front of their peers and parents. On the other hand, the three teachers differed in terms of how they make a balance between encouragement and punishment. Pevin suggests mostly encouragement like rewarding as better discipline methods to direct students. In contrast, Anne emphasizes the importance of being a strict father. Charlotte considers the balanced co-existence of both ways to direct learners' learning.

The teachers all tried to enhance their students' self-esteem by increasing their "real self" to match their "ideal self" as closer as possible. Moreover, they considered that the students' "situational" or "state" self-esteem in relation to English speaking harmed students' self-esteem in learning English to a large extent, since they were seriously careful while having students practicing speaking. They utilized some activities, such as speech, play and so on to provide students a chance to achieve "the mastery of a developmental task". The teachers encouraged the parents, too. In this way, the parents will display more hopeful attitude toward their kids in their learning. On the other hand, if a student is not motivated to learn, they do not push them too hard for fear of harming their self-esteem. Most importantly, they all praised students to have them sense their superiority.

In general, all the three teachers shared similar cases where their students displayed some kind of different learning difficulties. They used various and varied strategies to build up students' self-esteem.

However, I was wondering, what about those “ordinary” students, who do not usually attract attention from teachers. Will they feel being ignored and thus their self-esteem are harmed as teachers usually pay more attention to those who are weaker rather than them? Such negligence of ordinary students might wrongly direct students to perform worse than what they could actually achieve so as to purposely earn teachers’ attentions. Therefore, I had to admit that my research findings are particularly insightful for teachers who are dealing with academically low-achieved students.

In the literature, some scholars shared the view of the close relationships and feelings of self-esteem and the sense of superiority. A teacher may enhance one student’s self-esteem by expressing his or her superiority while hurting other students’ self-esteem at the same time as their performances are below the teacher’s expectation. This is especially the case when the teacher is praising one particular student in front of his or her classmates.

Another issue is that some students might take rewards or praises as a clue that they do not need to do more efforts at all as they’ve already won the teachers’ agreements or they’ve already achieved the learning goal to some extent, so that the students think they are “good” enough. Or, even, they refused praises as they do not believe they are good enough to be praised. This kind of situations did happen a lot when a student doesn’t want to learn at all. They may purely meet the requirement to pass a test. Their self-esteem does not need this subject to be enhanced but others.

I had met this kind of students. The interesting thing is the way I enhanced his

self-esteem was done by directly disciplining him first. I accused him of his lazy behavior of learning so directly that he cried. Surprisingly, he kindly tried to prove what I said is wrong to protect his self-esteem by improving. He earned my agreement and praise back. But, he turned back to be lazy after my confirming of his hard work of improving. I still trust this student according to the interaction between us. He is a kind-hearted and smart boy. In my heart, I believe that he will recall my praise and encouragement some day in the future, even though I may not see. I also learned a lot and retrospect myself in this case of my (in)appropriateness of teaching him.

Last tricky strategy utilized by my participants is the apology power. I have to say that they are all experienced and well-organized teachers who manage a class so well that the classroom discipline problems do not bother them that much. However, a commonly seen challenge faced by teacher trainees is that they are not able to use the power of the teacher as authority in a balanced way. Sometimes, they give students too much power when they are giving apology, which causes the teacher to lose their respectable images. Thus, the students will then not appreciate this teacher's praises or rewards, which consequently do not enhance their self-esteem.

To conclude, these experienced teachers provided strategies for teacher trainees to consider. They set their eyes on problematic students mostly. They usually assume academically weak students' self-esteem require more supports.

2. What were the beliefs or thoughts of the teachers toward elementary learners' self-esteem in relation to English learning?

Parents' supports, fair issues and the individual differences, are all the teachers' thoughts and beliefs toward learners' self-esteem and their English learning. However, Charlotte thinks her thoughts and beliefs are mostly from her teaching experiences, Anne takes her own learning experiences and family interactions as the source of her philosophy and Pevin values her colleagues' supports and ideas sharing that help her improve.

The three teachers have something in common in terms of how to take care of students' self-esteem. They shared the idea that a teacher needs to see the coexistence of their students' advantages and shortcomings. In this way, they are more inclined to see a student's value not only in academics like "linguistic goals" but also in other domains like "personality". The teachers believe what they say or tell the students will be seen as a truth that a student will believe in that they are what the teacher said so they carefully manipulate their power. The teachers know that it's not an easy job to maintain their positive emotions and words for the students but they also believe that "consistency" of providing positive interactions for students is a key to self-esteem enhancing strategies.

In addition, the teachers all mentioned the relationship of self-esteem and learning speaking. Moreover, it seems that the teachers all have positive faith toward elementary students' self-esteem, which means they all think elementary students' self-esteem are more flexible than adults to be enhanced. I, thus, emphasize the power of parents and individual

differences. Based on my own teaching experience, it is not easy to care for individual differences in public schools. For example, an English teacher in an elementary school has to teach about three hundred to four hundred students in average in Taichung City. They meet and teach three hundred to four hundred students forty minutes a week. Under such conditions, how are they able to attend to the students' individual differences?

In contrast, if a student goes to a language school, his or her English performance at his or her elementary school tests or homework will usually be outstanding. If a student doesn't go to a language school, his/her English performance will also be outstanding or okay as his/her parents follow his/her school works as an important reason shared by their home teachers. Their home teachers have more information of their performance of other subjects and connection records with the students' parents. Unfortunately, if a student doesn't go to a cram or language school, his/her performance of English could be really poor if his/her parents are not able to monitor their school works with them after school.

The point I want to make is that the students' self-esteem in learning English are not harmed merely by the teacher at a language school, cram school, elementary school, and parents but the policy and the design of the elementary English teaching and learning. Some students even told me he/she had already given up learning English even though he/she loved me to be her/his teacher since he/she was in her/his fourth grade. It is usually the case that in a primary school within such a limited time length of learning and teaching (40 minutes a week). Students are expected to be exposed to the maximum material with a large amount of

information. As a primary school teacher myself, I have to say that teachers have tried their super best to balance these crazy unreasonable conditions. It is a common sense in second language acquisition that the higher exposure to the target language input, the better a learner can learn in terms of listening, speaking, reading and writing. If the teachers can still keep their positive and hopeful attitude toward teaching and enhancing students' self-esteem under the customarily negative teaching and learning conditions in Taiwan, there are already the heroes of this dynasty.

3. What influences did the teachers have on their students' self-esteem?

Teacher Charlotte did improve Robin's self-esteem and his English learning as well as what Pevin did to Jimmy. More fortunately, Robin's and Jimmy's parents' self-esteem was enhanced as well. While, Jack still had to re-do a level and Vito's improvement was not able to be seen by Pevin right away, though Pevin has been informed by his next teacher that Vito seemed to have improved his emotion problems in relation to the peers.

All of the teachers had certain impact on these students. The reason is that the language school teachers are seen as powerful and mature professionals to the students attending the language school. Therefore, while they were announcing a student's "superiority", the other students may take it as true. Earning respect of a person, who you respect him/her, is a stable and absolute agreement and affirmation. A student will sense his/her value of being able to achieve something. More importantly, they were doing it better than others. I assume this has

direct connection of the competitive nature of human beings. This can help students to esteem themselves better as they will accept themselves because they may be weak in some ways but better in other ways and the pros and cons of them were both accepted by their teachers.

The teachers displayed their “involvement” while accompanying students’ works and they revealed their “expectations” as they believe that students will try to achieve what teachers expected them to do. Students will think what a teacher asked me to do is something I may be able to achieve and something the teacher believes I am able to achieve, so I shouldn’t disappoint him/her. Their beliefs had influence on students’ beliefs.

In my view, the influences the teachers had on the students were seen as a certain level of “change” onto or into a student’s cognition toward self. All these strategies including encouragements, agreements, praises, rewards or even apologies in words, facial expressions, attitudes, and actions can all be seen as an announcement of a piece of good news or a truth that happened to an individual as a result of their hard work. This declaration was clarified by the important others. That the student improved his/her performance is also a “change” in the student’s performance.

The “change” is the most valuable influence on the students’ self-esteem as it will lead the students’ to the right direction, such as working harder and help students to confirm and be noticed their values, specialties and existence. These angel teachers did have great influences on their students and their students’ self-esteem.

CHAPTER SEVEN

IMPLICATIONS & CONCLUSIONS

7.1 Implications and Suggestions for Teachers and Parents - Sandwich Strategy

This sandwich self-esteem enhancement strategy earns the most agreements among participants. The term ‘sandwich’ is used as an analogy which is easily understood to give a metaphor. The teachers expressed numerous elements and significant skills to follow. In order to conduct a more successful teaching for learners and interact with students’ self-esteem better, I re-organized the participants’ methods, strategies and skills for teachers and parents to take considerations and cooperate.

The successful teachers’ methods and strategies varied in surface structure, which meant the way they spoke to students but appeared similar in deep structure, which meant their goals. They all applied the so-called, ‘sandwich method’, which was termed by our native speaker supervisor Julie Jo.

The first piece of the sandwich includes a teacher’s acceptance of a learner, observation of a learner, understanding of a learner, appreciation of a learner’s specialties and rewarding or praise for a learner.

These efforts should be achieved with the learner, the teacher, his or her parents and their peers. This learner might be academically weak or slow so that a teacher might not be able to immediately discover his or her value when learning English but still needs to work with the

value of this learner's personality. Frances expresses this as the key to open the door of self-esteem enhancement.

This idea matches Vigil and Oller (1976) who provided a formal account of fossilization of a learner's trying to continue improving or not by a teacher's acceptance of the learner's advantages and shortcomings called "positive or negative affects or cognitive feedback". And, all the teachers emphasized the importance of positive supports.

The second piece of the sandwich starts from a connection or link to the learner's own value to his or her weakness especially on English learning. If a learner is academically good in some part of English learning, then the teacher will more easily be able to build on the learner's strengths and to try to overcome their weaknesses. However, if a learner has difficulty in learning English in many ways, then as teacher Anne did with the sporty student, she managed to link his English learning needs with his basketball interest.

Even more thought provoking is a teacher who may take chances to break a learner's self-esteem in this part to re-build it like what Anne did to lazy Jack after class. This period includes informing a learner his or her weakness and the possibilities to overcome them by their strength, communicating with the learner, finding solutions with the learner and trying to improve together with the learner.

Parents' cooperation or un-cooperation in any form can facilitate or harm the teachers working practice and results the most in this step. In this period, teachers and parents maybe need to let go of the English learning outcome first. Anne shared "learning English poorly

does not deny a student's value.”

Frances shared “if a teacher only wants a student to do this or that without treasuring his/her value, he/she will not do what the teacher and the parents expect”. This can mean this step will easily fail and also the student's English learning will be given in.

The last piece of the sandwich requires precise timing control and concise praise in any appropriate forms. Instant affirmation needs to be given directly to the learner. Clear, concise and understandable directions set out initially in learning English, to allow direction about their hard work and agreement of their success. The learner needs to be informed whether his/her real self matches his/her ideal self to some extent by the teachers, and parents so he/she is aware of his/her own supposed potential. In this piece, the learner is made aware of something he or she did better and hadn't achieved before. This enhanced not only the self-esteem of learners but also the teachers as well as the parents.

On the other hand, this period may not be seen immediately or may even occur in the future when the teacher is no longer with the learner. As Maggie said, “An educator has no right to give up”, which means a teacher may need to give up their expectation of seeing their hard work come to fruition in enhancing a student's self-esteem and learning outcome in the short term.

The beliefs or thoughts of self-esteem should be more flexible and adapt to a situation like what Frances mentioned about the important personalities of these three model teachers. They have to be really positive thinking people and be able to take on weaker or slower

students problems as common situations and deal with them professionally rather than personally. They have to believe in themselves rather than doubt their abilities to facilitate a learner even if they are unable to ‘change’ a learner’s situation right away dramatically. They have to process their own respective self-esteem first. They can try so hard to figure out better ways to deal with a learner’s self-esteem to enhance learning, but also have to learn to relinquish some control and allow the learner to figure out why they are not ‘good enough’ under their teaching.

To conclude, this ‘sandwich strategy’ seems to correspond to the ‘error treatment’ theory compiled by Brown (2000) in Vigil and Oller’s model (1976), which claims that “too much negative cognitive feedback ... often leads learners to shut off their attempts at communication... and providing enough red lights (which can mean the link from the first piece of the sandwich to the second piece is necessary) to call attention to those crucial errors”. Also, Skinner’s (1938) ‘operant conditioning model’ of learning in terms of ‘positive reinforcement’(which can mean the third piece of the sandwich of the teachers’ precise praise in concise timing) should also be taken into account while dealing with students to provide them with positive feedback.

If a teacher does try hard to figure out better ways to deal with a learner’s self-esteem and enhance their learning, the learners may turn out to be like Robin and Jimmy. They discovered their own specialties when learning English due to safe learning environments, where they were allowed to think for themselves, build their valuable self-esteem and learn to

interact with others. If a teacher tries too hard to ask a learner to figure out why they are not 'good enough' with no support, then the students could end up like Frances who hated math for years. Frances became a student who never thought she would be able to learn math as her teacher had already questioned her ability to learn by asking her, "why don't you understand?" It might seem easy to differentiate the two while merely discussing it but it can be really confusing in practice. A teacher can observe their learners' feedback and responses from their learning outcomes to reflect which kinds of the two a teacher has been.

7.2 Limitation of this Study and Implications for Researchers

The teachers' perceptions of their students, their feedbacks and afterthought were the focuses and sources of data of this study. The data were therefore based on the observation and perception of the teachers involved and not directly from the learners themselves. The reason for this was the ease of data collection from adults in a more organized fashion of feelings and situation explanations. Therefore, the data collected would tend to be more subjective.

However, the perspectives of learners or parents had their weakness in nature. Opinions of learners can be feelings full of adjectives and preferences of a particular teacher rather than how the teachers interact with them, teach them and enhance their self-esteem. If the case (i.e., student) shared by the teacher is somewhat long time ago, the "feeling" of that learner may not be fresh enough. As an outsider, letting the participant teachers choose a particular learner

as an interviewee may cause bias. Similar to the perspectives of students, parents' opinions can also be irrelevant to the learners' self-esteem building-up. Therefore, various perspectives from the boss, colleagues who had observed the three angel teachers, a total outsider, Maggie, and I can provide a more trustworthy overall view on how the three participant teachers enhanced learners' self-esteem especially in the process.

7.3 Findings of this study and Suggestions for Researchers

Some findings of the study have some inspirations for teachers to take serious considerations. Teacher Anne and teacher Frances all mentioned that some students were forced to learn rather than were supposed to learn English in our language school in a certain age. The state of minds of the students can induce their low motivations to learn and cause low learning achievement, which harm the students' self-esteem. Therefore, regardless of the well-planned strategies by which teachers are trying do to improve the students' self-esteem and English learning outcomes, teachers also need to consider the students' unwillingness problems.

Another issue mentioned by all the teachers is the effect of learning speaking on self-esteem. It seems that the teachers all agreed that speaking can either damage a learner's self-esteem to a large extent or facilitate a learner's confidence sufficiently. This implies that "learning speaking" is a significant key to success in self-esteem building, so teachers have to make good use of it.

Parents like to say that teachers' words are much more effective or useful than their own advice for their children. However, all the teachers emphasized the crucial role of parents to facilitate learners' self-esteem as the teachers observed the desire of the students to earn their parents' acknowledgment of their hardworking.

Teacher Sharon and Frances mentioned that a teacher may need to set different goals for different students, which seems to be contradictory to the fair issue mentioned by Anne and Evita. This is another tricky and artful skill that requires teachers to conduct carefully.

In teacher Anne's learning experience, "the ex-classmates who will not invite the six students who went to tutor to the class reunions are ALL boys. My other girl classmates and I do not mind so much", Anne added. This reminds me of a research finding in literature that parents' being indifferent and absent effect may be particularly important for male children as Miller (1984) mentioned and all my participants shared cases involved male students. The accounts from the participant teachers about the boys may tend to be a bit subjective as none of them shared a female student story with me. In the step of choosing participants, I had no access to locate a male teacher. This can be a limitation of my study. Therefore, I would like to suggest the researcher who is interested in similar topic pick male teachers and have female students in their stories to see if this gender issue causes varieties.

The finding earns the most agreement among teachers of this study which is actually my favorite one is the power of giving apology to the students by their teachers. The value of receiving apology from a teacher to students has been highly approved by all the participant

teachers.

7.4 Conclusions

In the end, I want to conclude my study by some of the ideas teacher Sharon shared with me. She shared a theory with me, which she thinks is highly related to self-esteem. It's called the Pygmalion Effect. Merton (1948) defined the Pygmalion Effect "as a participant's expectations will truly cause them to come true", which is called a self-fulfilling prophecy. Sharon quoted this idea saying that, "If a teacher says a student is 'so and so', then the student will really be 'so and so'." Sharon buys this theory very much as she has found it to be true in her experiences of teaching. She said, "If a teacher always informs a student that he/she is bad at something, he/she will really keep being bad at it rather than correcting it as a negative reinforcement." "Conversely if a teacher says they are good at something, then, this student will keep being good at it as a positive reinforcement." With such undertaking from the teacher, students will change their "real self" for the better and approach as close as to the "ideal self", expected by themselves as well as their significant others (e.g., teachers, parents, etc.). This has great implications for teachers when they are interacting with learners in their daily practice.

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APPENDIXES

Interview Questions

Appendix A

The Interview Questions for the Three Main Participant Teachers

Part One: Cases Discussions:

1. Please give me some examples that you enhanced learners' self-esteem to facilitate their

English learning or improve their English learning

outcomes, which enhanced their self-esteem. It can happen in class,

before class or after class in your interaction with them.

請給我幾個提升學生自尊進而提升他們的英文學習成效的例子，或者英文學習成效進步進而提升學生自尊的例子，這互動可以發生於課堂中課後或者課前。

2. Please give me some examples that you damaged learners' self-esteem. As a result, you

harm their English learning or their English learning outcomes. It can happen in class,

before class or after class in your interaction with them.

請給我幾個傷害學生自尊因此降低他們英文學習成效的例子，或者英文學習成效退步因此降低學生自尊的例子，這互動可以發生於課堂中課後或者課前。

Followed Questions (prompts)

(1). When and how do/did you know him/her? (Which grade, which level, are you his/her first teacher in the language school in a new class, redo or transferred from other scheduled class or other cram school systems)

您是什麼時候或者說如何認識他/她的，比如說他/她是幾年級，什麼級數，您是他/她在何嘉仁的第一位老師嗎(開新班)，或是他/她被降轉後接到的學生，或是轉班到您的班上比如因為時段不適合原班，或是從其他系統轉到何嘉仁等等。

(2). How long do/did you teach him/her?

您教了他多久的時間，幾個級數，或是說從他幾年級到幾年級。

(3). What's his/her performance when you first taught him/her in terms of speaking, reading, listening reading, spelling, grammar, homework, classroom participation, telephone test and so on?

您一開始教他時，他的各方面表現如何，包括聽，說，讀，寫，文法，單字，作業，課堂參予，以及電話測驗等等。

(4). Interaction examples in, before or after class? (Common interactions, problem solving interactions)

您印象中互動的例子，舉凡課前課後及課堂中，可以是一般例行性的互動，比如回答問題，作活動練習，或者是叫特殊的互動，比如有遇到什麼狀況問題需要解決時。

(5). What's his or her interaction/friendship with mates?

他/她與班上其他同學的互動或者說友誼關係如何?

(6). What are their parents like?

就與您的互動經驗中了解到她/他的父母親是怎樣的家長？

- (7). What's his/her performance after you taught him/her in terms of speaking, reading, listening reading, spelling, grammar, homework, classroom participation, telephone test and so on?

您教他之後，他的各方面表現如何，包括聽，說，讀，寫，文法，單字，作業，課堂參予，以及電話測驗等等。

- (8). What are you like in his/her mind?

您在他的心目中又是個怎樣的師長呢？

- (9). In your view, what makes him/her improve or enhance his/her performance?

在您的心中或許是假設或者是認定他/她的改善與進步因素為何？

Part Two: Thoughts Sharing

1. What are your beliefs and thoughts on self-esteem in relation to English learning?

在您的想法或信念中，您認為自尊是什麼或者說是怎麼樣的，（如何提升，破壞，穩定，可變動，不重要，影響深遠等等），它與英語學習的關聯呢？

Followed Questions (prompts)

- (1). Do you think English is more difficult to learn compared with other subjects. It is easier or harder to enhance or damage students' self-esteem compared with other subjects, or the other way round?

你認為英語這個科目比起其他科目有沒有較難學習的地方或原因，是否也因此較容

易傷害自尊或較不易去建立自尊或反之？

(2). In terms of enhancing students' self-esteem, do you believe in using wholly positive encouragement or using punishment and rewarding system at the same time? Why?

在您的信念中，為了提升或建立自尊，你較認同全部正面鼓勵加強或是賞罰分明？

(3). Regardless of parents' influence, to what extent do English teachers have in terms of their influence on learners' self-esteem?

暫且撇開家長的因素，您認為英語老師對於孩子的自尊能有多大或是怎樣的影響力？

2. What are your self learning experience and self-reflective practice?

可以分享一下您自身的學習經驗以及對此經驗的反思與身為師長後的實踐嗎？

Followed Questions (prompts)

(1). Are your beliefs in self-esteem the same with or different from your own teachers/parents?

(When did you meet your teacher(s)/parent(s), e.g., which level, elementary, junior high, senior and so on.)and Why?

您對於孩子的自尊及英語教育的信念與您以往的師長或是雙親相違背或符合嗎？是什麼年級時遇到的師長？為什麼相符何或違背？

(2). Are they from your experiences of teaching or colleagues, supervisors and so on?

又或者您的信念是來自於你本身的教學經驗，同事，主管等等？

3. Do the beliefs change? Why or why not?

這些對於孩子自尊與英語學習的信念是否改變，為什麼？

4. How do you retain those beliefs when you encounter challenges from learners or others?

當您的信念遇到一些挑戰時，比如來自學生，家長，外師，主管等等，這些信念是否改變，或者如何改變，又或者您如何保持它？

Followed Questions (prompts)

(1). Do the beliefs change when you are more and more experienced?

當您越來越有經驗時，信念與一開始當老師有何不同？

(2). Do the beliefs change when you encounter frustrations of learners, parents, supervisors or colleagues?

當您遇到挫敗時，比如來自學生，家長，外師，主管等等，信念如何調整，持續或者改變。

(3). Why does it change (or doesn't change)? (Is it about patience and passion?)

如果改變了或者持續，與您的熱情或耐心有怎樣的關係？

Appendix B

The Interview Questions for Colleagues

1. According to your observation, do teachers enhance or damage learners' self-esteem, which facilitates or harm students' English learning by how?

就您的觀察，某某老師是否提升或者傷害了孩子的自尊，因為有益於或者有害於孩子的英語學習。

Followed Questions (prompts)

- (1). Can you give me an example that the teacher enhanced the learner's self-esteem by how?

(Did you have a discussion about the situation with the teacher or others?)

可否請您給我一個老師(這三位或其他)提升孩子自尊的例子，是如何提升的，或許您還與這位老師請教過這個狀況。

- (2). Can you give me an example that the teacher damaged the learner's self-esteem by how?

(Did you have a discussion about the situation with the teacher or others?)

可否給我一個老師(這三位或其他)傷害孩子自尊的狀況，是如何發生的，或許您還與這位老師討論過您的看法。

2. Why do you think the learners' self-esteem is enhanced or damaged in English learning?

您為何認為孩子的自尊被提升或者被傷害了？

Followed Questions (prompts)

(1). If the learner's self-esteem is damaged, what do you think is a better mean to the case?

Please give examples

如果是傷害了，您覺得是否有更好的方式來處理這個孩子或者當時的情況。比如說？

3. What have you learned from them (e.g., to apply the ideas/skills/principles) in your class to enhance learners' self-esteem to facilitate English learning or to prevent harming to students' self-esteem?

您從這位老師身上學習到什麼，可以應用他們的技巧，原則，主意到您的課堂中來提升孩子的自尊以便增進英文學習，或者反之如何避免一些錯誤的方式去傷害孩子的自尊。

Followed Questions (prompts)

(1). What did you apply and how did you apply in you class?

您應用了什麼或者如何應用到您的課堂中。

(2). Did you apply it in your class directly or refine it? Why?

就照他們的方式直接應用到您的課堂中還是做了些許的調整，為什麼？

Appendix C

The Interview Questions for the Supervisor

The interview questions for Colleague Teachers added appendix C will be the interview questions for the supervisor.

Supervisor only

4. What have you suggested the teachers (e.g., to apply the ideas/skills/principles) in your experiences to enhance learners' self-esteem to facilitate English learning or to prevent harming students self-esteem?

您對老師們提供什麼建議，從您的經驗中，應用您的技巧，主意，原則，以提升學生自尊增進英語學習。

Followed Questions (prompts)

- (1). What and how did you suggest in what situations?

您如何建議他們？建議了什麼？

- (2). How did they respond to your suggestions? (Take into considerations or refuse them) ?

他們的反應如何，認同且納入考慮，或者拒絕，是因為怎樣不同的想法差異？

Appendix D

The Analysis Sample

The data analysis was based on the basic elements of Narrative Analysis method framed by Labov (1972).

TABLE 6 Labov's (1972) basic structures of narrative analysis elements

Order	Basic structure	Elements
1	abstract	
2	condition	Time
		Place
		Context
		Participants
3	order of factors	
4	value	significance
		meaning
5	attitude	
6	solutions	what happened
		result

Teacher Charlotte's origin text of the transcriptions

1. 我曾經有一個很特殊的經驗，
2. 就是那個小孩子他有口吃的狀況，
3. 那媽媽在這個方面對於他口吃又學語言其實很擔心，期望也很大，
4. 也很擔心他常常遭受到學生的嘲笑，然後自尊越來越少，自信越來越小這樣子，
5. 可是他在我們班
6. 我覺得也很好
7. 就是家長對小孩子的一個教育，還有他關心的程度，還有他的一個明理的程度
8. 其實是對小孩子有很正面
9. 很大的影響，
10. 所以他是一個昌平的新班
11. 我從一級就開始接這個班級，
12. 他是三年級，
13. 然後媽媽在這方面就有在一開始就跟我做溝通，就是一開始就有主動跟我做溝通
14. 我也很感謝這位家長
15. 因為其實老師要面對這麼多學生
16. 她不可能一開始、需要一些些時間才能摸索小孩子的一些個性，然後他的一個需要幫助的地方在哪裡
17. 但是在摸索的過程中你很容易就讓小孩子覺得
18. 可能你做了哪些事情，雖然不是，你只是做一般的事情



中原大學

19. 但是對特殊的小孩子來說，或許造成了傷害你卻不知道，

Re-ordered text as a description of the original story added labels, analysis and comments that related to self-esteem

10. 所以他是一個昌平的新班(condition-time, order)

11. 我從一級就開始接這個班級，(condition-time, order)

13. 然後媽媽在這方面就有在一開始就跟我做溝通，就是一開始就有主動(value-meaning)

跟我做溝通(condition-participant, context, order of factors)

-parents' supporting

2. 就是那個小孩子他有口吃的狀況，(abstract-factor, condition-participant)

-speaking learning

12. 他是三年級，(condition-time，context，participant)

3. 那媽媽在這個方面對於他口吃又學語言其實很擔心(condition-participant

，value-significance)，期望也很大(condition-value-attitude)，

4. 也很擔心他常常遭受到學生的嘲笑，然後自尊越來越少，自信越來越小這樣子，

(condition-participant，condition-value-attitude，significance)

-peer effect that damage speaking learning and self-esteem

5. 可是他在我們班(condition-place)

6. 我覺得也很好(condition-value-attitude of narrator)

15. 因為其實老師要面對這麼多學生(condition-context, participant)

-challenges to overcome

16. 她不可能一開始(order of factor)、需要一些些時間(order of factor)才能摸索小孩子的一些個性，然後他的一個需要幫助的地方在哪裡，(condition-context, participant)

-cooperation of parents and the teacher

14. 我也很感謝這位家長(value-meaning, attitude)

17. 但是在摸索的過程中你很容易就讓小孩子覺得，(value-solution-result, order of factor)

18. 可能你做了哪些事情，雖然不是，你只是做一般(value)的事情，(condition-context, participant)

19. 但是對特殊的(value)小孩子來說，或許造成了傷害你卻不知道，
(condition-solution-result)

-things to prevent from harm on students' self-esteem

7. 就是家長對小孩子的一個教育，還有他關心的程度，還有他的一個明理的程度，
(condition-participant, value-meaning, attitude)

8. 其實是對小孩子有很正面(condition-participant, value-significance, solution)

-facilitate self-esteem

9. 很大的影響，(condition-participant, value-solution)

1. 我曾經有一個很特殊的經驗，(abstract, condition-value-meaning)